

**Duneway Ventures**

# Alternative Credit & Payment infrastructure for MENA's emerging private sector

*Investment Recommendation*

DUBAI



CAIRO



RIYADH



LONDON



**DUNEWAY**  
VENTURES  
CAPITAL PATHWAYS TO MENA

# Our Mission

*Investing in early-stage solutions revolutionizing the payment and credit infrastructure for MENA's emerging private sector.*

**MENA** is a relatively young, high-growth market with significant untapped potential, and the private sector is not yet keeping pace with public sector goals.

**Backed by major regional reform agendas:**

- **Saudi Vision 2030**
- **UAE's We the UAE 2031**
- **Jordan's Economic Modernization Vision 2033**
- **Egypt Vision 2030**

## Core Fund Identity

Fund Size

**\$20 mn**

Ticket Size

**\$400k–\$1.5 M**

Stage

**Seed–  
Series A**

**Fund Base: Dubai, UAE**

## Methodology

### Deal Sourcing

**Outbound:** Direct founder outreach via LinkedIn and internal network

**Inbound:** Attend events like GITEX

### Team & Market Evaluation

**Team:** Evaluated via frameworks and Advisory board input

**Market:** Ecosystem mapping & industry primary research

### Investment Approach

**Return:** 18–24% IRR, 2.3–4.5x MOIC

**Horizon:** 5–8 years.

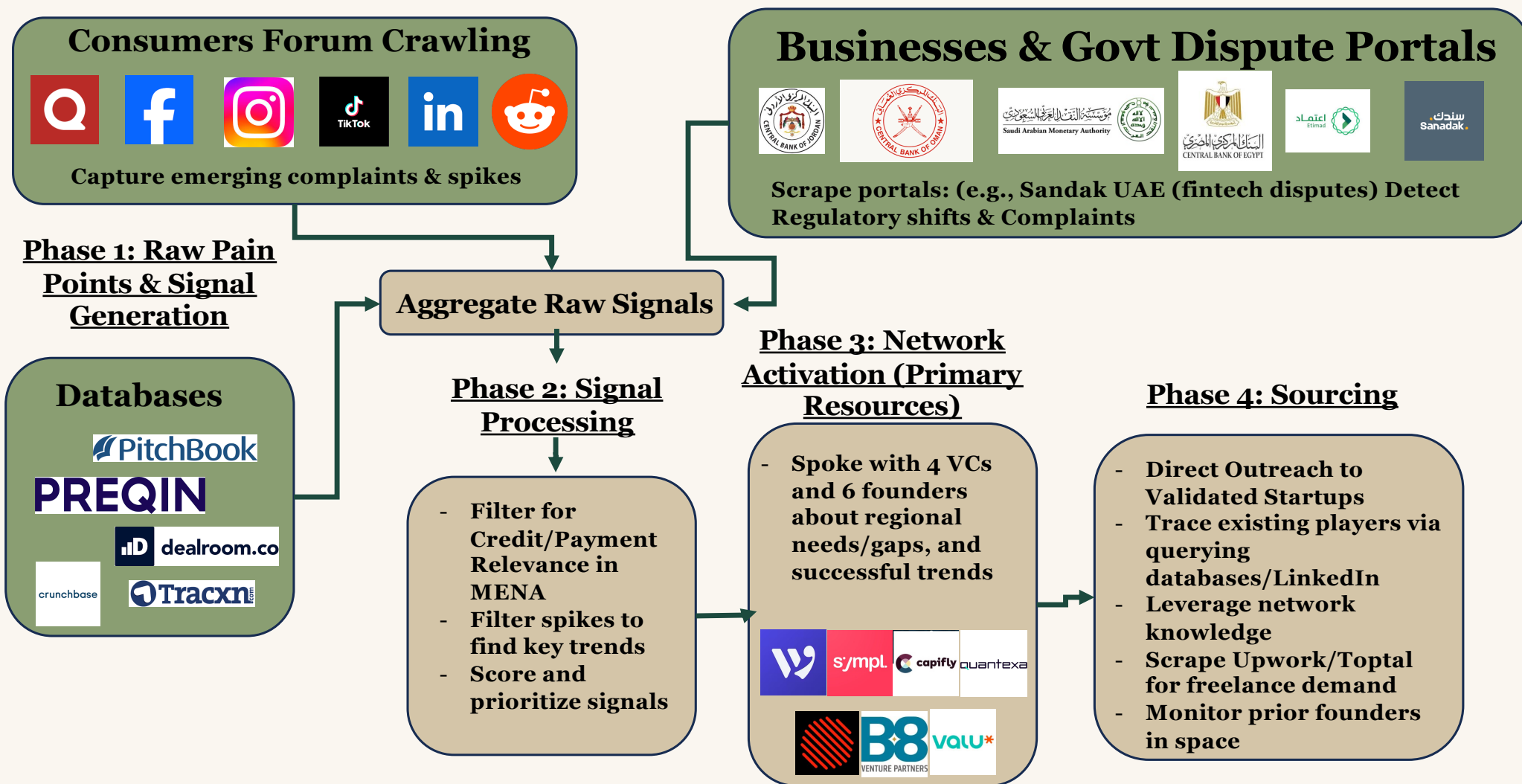
**Companies:** 10–12

**Follow Up:** 20%

### Founder Support

Hands-on guidance, access to regional network, regulatory support, go-to-market adaptation & partnership with other portfolio companies

# Deal Sourcing



# Team

## Management



**Kanz Majdalawi**  
**General Partner**

3 Years industry experience  
in MENA | Geopolitical  
Analyst @ Azure Strategy |  
MENA Research @ Chatham  
House | Founder @  
Mustathmira| BSc History,  
Politics, Economics @ UCL



**Karim Abbas**  
**Managing Partner**

MSc VC, PE & Fintech @  
UCL | Treasury Markets @  
Standard Chartered |  
Chartered Banker @  
Chartered Banker Institute  
| BSc Banking & Finance @  
UoL

## Advisory Team



**Peyman Mestchian**  
Quantexa/ 2x Fintech  
Exits



**Maher Aoun**  
VP @Wafeq / Mellon  
Capital/ Stanford



**Omar Kamal**  
B8 Ventures/ ex-  
fintech Arab Bank



**Dr. Fawaz Gerges**  
Professor of Middle  
Eastern Studies @LSE

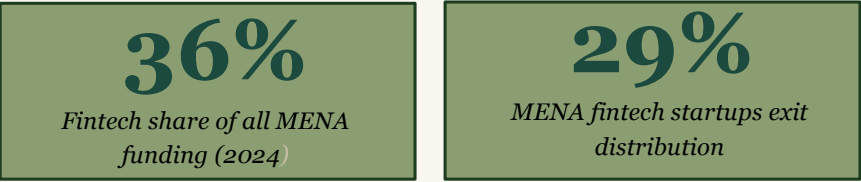
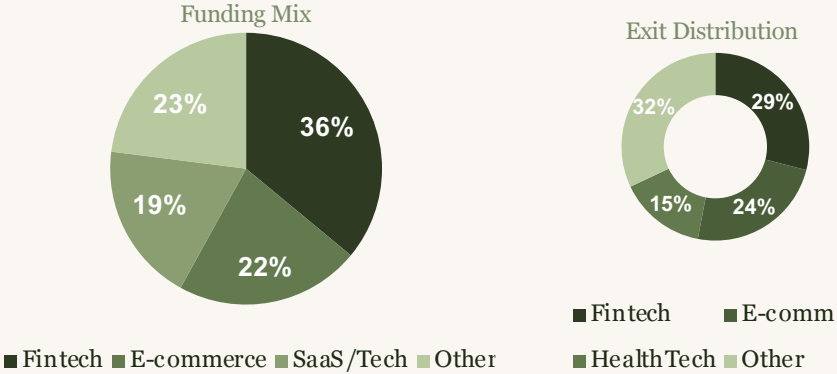
# Payment & Credit in MENA

MENA is the fastest-growing fintech region globally with 35% annual net revenue growth projected until 2028, more than double the global average of 15%.

MARKET DATA



MENA 2024 Sector Funding Mix & Exit Distribution



GAPS IN MENA

| SME Credit Desert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Cross-Border Payments                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Islamic Finance Gap                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>96% / 8%</div> <div>SMEs registered businesses, yet receive only 8% of total bank lending</div> <div><ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>SME lending share as low as 2% in GCC countries</li><li>Root causes: risk aversion, limited credit histories, fragmented financial records, exclusion of micro-businesses</li><li>Opportunity: alternative underwriting via AI + alternative data is making SME lending viable at scale</li></ul></div> | <div>38M+</div> <div>International migrants in the Middle East</div> <div><ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>GCC has significant intra-regional trade + a massive migrant worker population, but payment rails remain fragmented and expensive</li><li>Migrants are 50%+ of GCC total population, exceeding 85% in Qatar and UAE, one of the highest concentrations globally</li></ul></div> | <div>\$306B</div> <div>Islamic fintech vol. by 2027</div> <div><ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Most fintechs in the region either ignore Shariah compliance or treat it as a cost centre, a structural gap</li><li>Startups building Shariah-compliant credit infrastructure gain a natural moat in Saudi Arabia, the UAE, and broader MENA</li></ul></div> |

Sources: Fast Company ME, King & Spalding MENA Fintech Report, Global Islamic Fintech Report 2023/2024, GCC Migration Data · Chainalysis

# WHY NOW?

**\$170B+**

Market size, growing 27.8% annually with 17% digital banking penetration vs 60% in the US. The gap is the opportunity.

**\$3.96T**

Islamic finance industry, largely undigitised, seeking Shariah-compliant infrastructure that barely exists yet.

**\$100B+**

Committed by GCC governments to AI in 2024 alone, creating a regulatory and capital tailwind unlike any other region.

01

## Islamic Finance

### Culturally Viable Solutions

Shariah-compliant digital finance — a \$3.96T industry barely touched by technology

**\$3.96T**

Global Islamic finance industry

**+122%**

Islamic fintech growth 2022→2027

**\$306B**

Projected fintech vol. by 2027

**17%**

MENA digital banking vs 60% in US

02

## AI-Native

### Fintech Infrastructure

GCC governments treating AI as economic diversification — fintech is the primary vehicle

**\$40B**

Saudi Arabia AI commitment (2024)

**\$100B**

MGX AI fund — Mubadala + G42

**27.8%**

MENA fintech annual growth rate

**36%**

Fintech share of all MENA funding

03

## Alternative

### Payments & Crypto

MENA emerging as the world's most active regulated digital asset hub

**\$338.7B**

MENA on-chain transactions 2023–24

**+42%**

UAE crypto growth vs 11.7% global avg

**7th**

MENA global crypto market rank

**7.5%**

MENA share of global crypto activity

# Investment Recommendation



**Bokra**

 Egypt · Pre seed: \$4.6M



**Stream**

 KSA · Seed: \$4M

 **SaturnX**

 UAE · Seed: \$3M

| Metric          | BOOKRA                                                    | STREAM                                            | SATURNX                                                                                                                         |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Regulatory Moat | 16 FRA licences, 3-5 years to replicate                   | SAMA rails only table stakes                      | Licences not disclosed, UAE 2024 Payment Token Services Regulation (PTSR), Cross-border stablecoin <b>beyond UAE</b> very risky |
| Product Breadth | B2C savings + B2B credit                                  | B2B billing only                                  | B2B stablecoin payments                                                                                                         |
| Team            | 120+ yrs fintech CEO 21 yrs sukuk FRA network             | Solo first-time CEO · <b>high key-person risk</b> | CEO 15+ yrs FX/treasury · strongest founder profile                                                                             |
| Traction        | 45K users · \$60M sukuk executed, 16 FRA licenses         | 40% MoM growth, <b>MENA expansion (risky)</b>     | \$250M+ volume in 5 months · profitable at launch                                                                               |
| Market Timing   | EGP -70% · \$46B SME gap · Growing Islamic Finance demand | Vision 2030 tailwind · widely shared              | Stablecoin adoption rising, UAE to be positioned as a global crypto hub.                                                        |
| VERDICT         | INVEST                                                    | WATCH                                             | WATCH                                                                                                                           |
| PRIMARY         |                                                           |                                                   |                                                                                                                                 |

Sources: Bokra, SaturnX, Stream, Pitchbook, Bloomberg

## Why Bokra

### Competitive Advantage

16 FRA licences. No competitor holds equivalent coverage.

### Tech

B2C savings fund sukuk pools; SMEs draw credit; returns flow back to savers.

### Catalyst

EGP -70%, \$46B structural credit gap, Sharia digital demand independent drivers hitting simultaneously.

### Traction

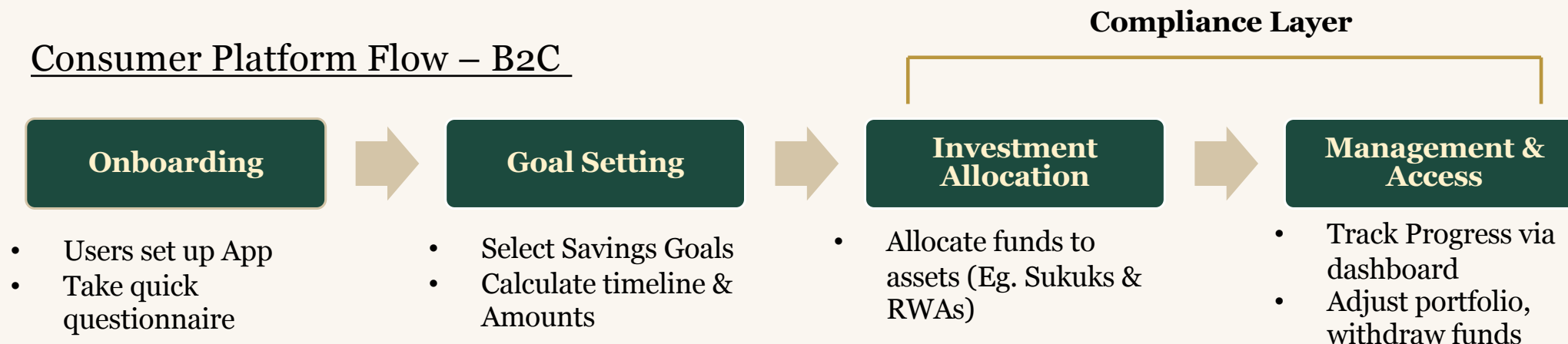
\$60M sukuk executed. 45K users. \$4.6M raised pre-seed. FRA sign-off.

### Team

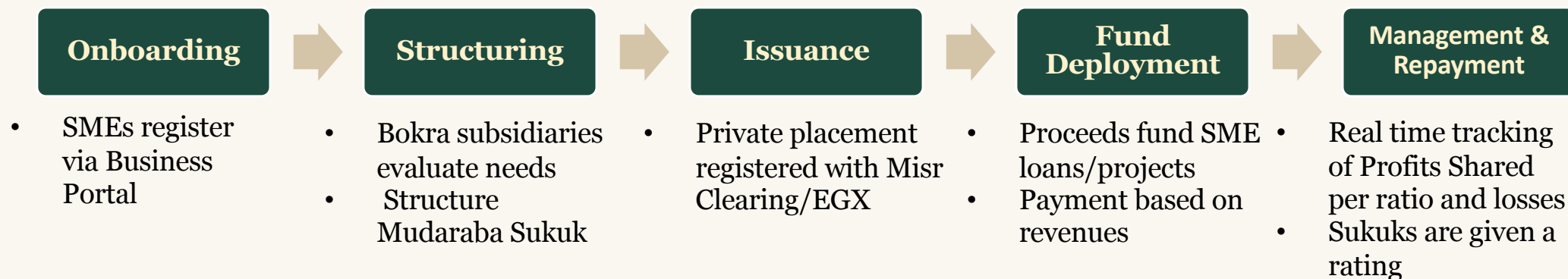
CEO Elsayy: 21 yrs sukuk + existing FRA relationships. 120+ combined yrs across the team.

# Bokra Product and Technology

## Consumer Platform Flow – B2C



## SME Platform Flow – B2B



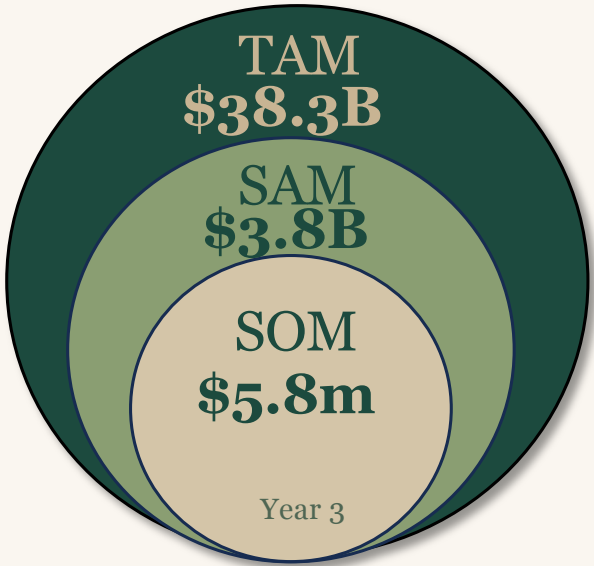


# Bokra Market Analysis

## Bottom-Up Market Sizing

| Revenue Stream              | Year 3 Target Metric      | Average Volume / Ticket | Total Managed Volume | Applied Fee Rate  | Projected Revenue |
|-----------------------------|---------------------------|-------------------------|----------------------|-------------------|-------------------|
| Credit (Murabaha / SME)     | 1,200 SME Borrowers       | \$40,000 per loan       | \$48.00 Million      | 3.50% (Midpoint)  | \$1.68 Million    |
| Savings & Investments (AUM) | 800 SMEs + 50k Retail     | Blended AUM             | \$220.00 Million     | 1.00% (Midpoint)  | \$2.20 Million    |
| Platform Transactions       | 70,000 Total Active Users | \$1,000 annual volume   | \$70.00 Million      | 2.50% (Take Rate) | \$1.75 Million    |
| Total Bottom-Up SOM         |                           |                         |                      |                   | \$5.63 Million    |

## Top Down-Market Sizing



\$225B MENA credit gap, \$13.2B representing the Islamic SME credit gap in MENA, \$3.3B gap in Egypt + \$35B retail savings/investment gap in Egypt

10% of the gap is addressable via digital native solutions

Assuming 5% market capture in 3 years, with a take rate of 3%

TAM

Blended

SAM

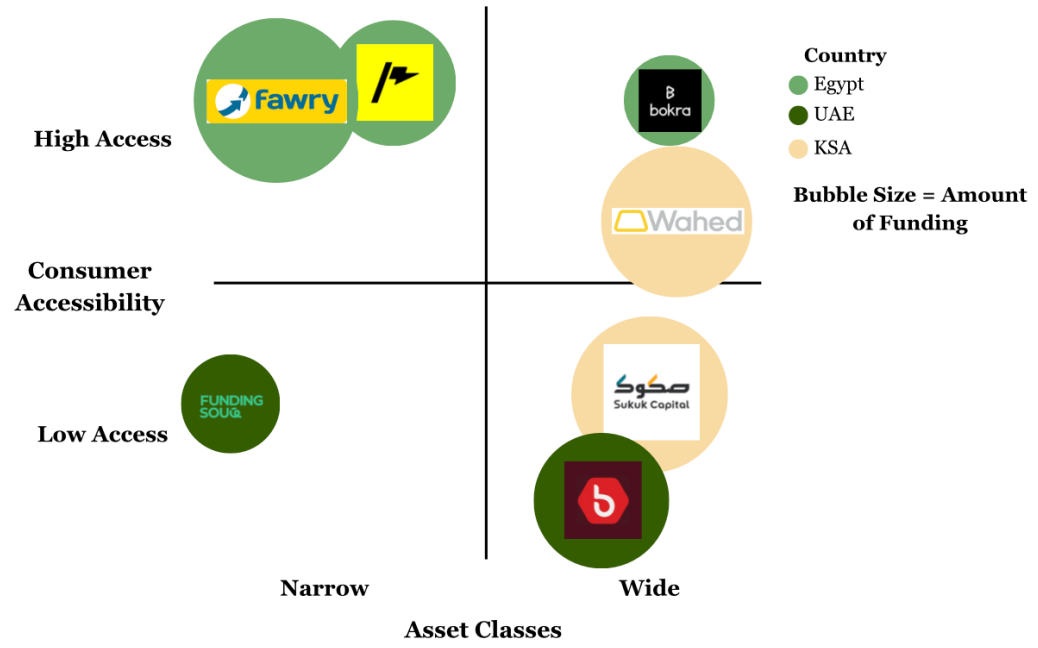
Blended

SOM

Blended

# Bokra Competitors & GTM

## Competitors



Existing direct competitors like Thndr and Fawry predominantly offer access to Egyptian equities or low-yield savings accounts, while current domestic competitors do not focus on Sukuks (high yield savings), giving Bokra a market advantage.

Sources: Pitchbook, Bloomberg, McKinsey & Company, Bokra, Businesswire, Visa, WorldBank, Gulf News, Tabby

## Go to Market (Summary Extract)

| Segment            | Target Audience                 | Core Hook                             | Current GTM                               | Long-Term                                 |
|--------------------|---------------------------------|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| Retail banked      | Bank customers in Egypt         | High-yield Sharia savings in assets   | Online marketing                          | Co-branded campaigns, goal-based journeys |
| Retail/underbanked | Cash/gig workers, youth         | Simple halal savings wallet           | Online Marketing/field marketing          | Financial Literacy Programs               |
| SME borrowers      | Micro/small businesses, drivers | Sukuk/revenue financing via portal    | Anchor verticals like Aman/Rehla          | Deepen verticals, bundle savings          |
| Institutions       | MFIs, leasing firms             | Portfolio securitization/distribution | Lead arranger for Aman and partner sukuku | Customizable backend infrastructure       |

# Bokra Team

| Name           | Title                   | Background           | Strength            |
|----------------|-------------------------|----------------------|---------------------|
| Ayman Elsayy   | CEO & Co-founder        | Finance Veteran      | Credit Expertise    |
| Mohamad Sallam | Chief Business Officer  | Business Development | Market Scaling      |
| Samer Sallam   | Co-founder & Non-Exe    | Serial Entrepreneur  | Operational Network |
| Mohamed Khadra | Chief Marketing Officer | Fintech Marketer     | Growth Marketing    |



## Team Assessment:

| Metric                      | Evaluation Criteria                              | Assessment Basis                                                                      | Score (1–5) |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| Skills                      | Founder Alignment with Company Needs             | Elsawy's 21 yrs non-bank finance/sukuk fits Sharia SME credit. Team 120+ yrs fintech. | 5           |
| Cohesion                    | Role clarity across team                         | Clear roles: Elsayy CEO vision, Sallam founder, Mohamad business, Khadra marketing.   | 4           |
| Integrity & Trustworthiness | Alignment with investor expectations             | Credible: \$4.6M funding, EGP 3B sukuk, FRA license; regulated backgrounds.           | 4           |
| Execution Risk              | Dependence on original Founder                   | High on Elsayy (no backup for expertise); execs capable but less visionary.           | 3           |
| Motivation & Commitment     | Willingness & Ability to accept opportunity cost | Strong post-2023: app relaunch, funding despite stable prior roles.                   | 5           |
| Complementarity             | Complementary Team Skill Set                     | Balanced: finance (Elsawy), scaling (Sallam), payments (Khadra/Okasha).               | 4           |
| Experience                  | Prior startup / Exit Experience                  | Moderate startups (Naqla \$10.5M, Cowpay); lacks exits, first-time scaling.           | 3           |

Sources: Bokra, Gompers et al., 2020, Pitchbook

# Bokra Risk Analysis (Summary Extract)

| Risk            | Description                                      | Current Risk                                          | Mitigation                                   | Future Risk                                                                     |
|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Regulatory      | Changes in FRA/Sharia rules                      | Low                                                   | Compliance focus (has 16 licenses until now) | Medium (expansion)                                                              |
| Market Adoption | Slow unbanked uptake                             | Medium (45k users)                                    | Marketing and bank customer outreach         | Medium                                                                          |
| Sales Execution | Acquiring/retaining customers amid MENA hurdles  | Medium (early growth stage/ Current market advantage) | Targeted outreach, sales training            | High (profitability pressure)                                                   |
| Scalability     | Reg fragmentation, infra/talent gaps in MENA     | Low (Egypt-focused)                                   | Partnerships, AI efficiency                  | Very High (cross-border challenging due to regulation and cultural differences) |
| Tech            | Cyber threats to app/biometrics, system failures | Low (enhanced app 2025)                               | Prohibited uses policy, secure platforms     | Medium (attack surface growth)                                                  |

Sources: Masaar.net, Ardent Privacy, ICLG.com, Clyde & Co, FF News, Arageek (2025), Empower Africa, Google Play, McKinsey, Lucidity Insights, Tech in Africa, Bokra.com, The Digital Banker (2024), Bokra

# Investment Preference

## Stage Investment

### Seed - Series A

Predicting Seed-Series A investment in 2027-2028

## Pre-Money Valuation

**\$26.8M**

Blended valuation from Scorecard and VC method

## Investment Amount

**\$1.2M**

## Implied Ownership Stake

**3-4%**

We are expecting a \$6-7M round, aligning with the median of deals in the sector/region

## Key Remaining Questions

- How liquid will their sukuks be?
- What will the default rate on Bokra's loans be?
- Can they scale across Egypt, and will they scale further in MENA?

*Translated quote from CEO of Bokra: We would want to eventually scale to a country “culturally similar to Egypt”*

## Investment Rationale

Bokra's **\$60M sukuk execution + 16 FRA licenses** = larger regulatory moat in Egypt's SME credit gap, amplified by -70% EGP collapse. **Any investment would require protective terms:** board seat with veto on expansion/capital raises, 1x liquidation preference, 18-month founder lock-up, and full-ratchet anti-dilution to mitigate execution and macro downside..

# Thank You

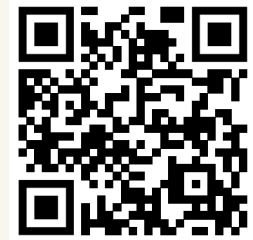
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## Questions?

Connect with us on **LinkedIn**



Karim Abbas



Kanz Majdalawi

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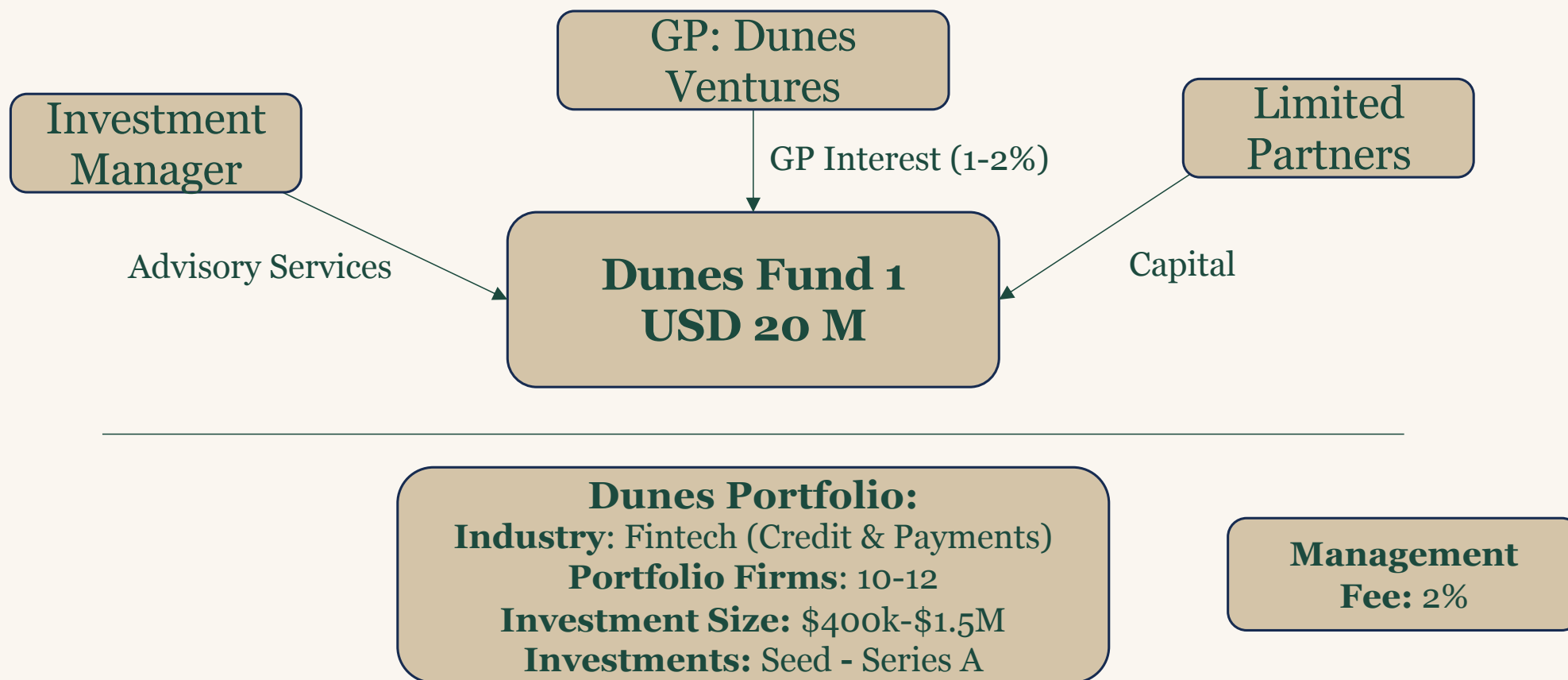


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# Appendix: Fund Structure



# Appendix: Our Advisors Background



Peyman Mestchian

Peyman Mestchian is a fintech and AI expert with over 25 years in finance, risk management, and technology; he founded and led firms like Chartis Research as Managing Partner (sold to Infopro Digital), served as CEO of Risktech (sold to Hexaware), held senior roles at SAS Institute and EY, and was Head of Corporate Development at Quantexa where he led strategy and M&A from 2018 to 2021, and now sits on their Board as an Advisor.



Maher Aoun

Maher Aoun is a fintech and SaaS sales leader with 15+ years' experience across EMEA, Southeast Asia, and the USA, currently driving growth as VP of Sales and Business Development at Wafeq. He previously held senior regional roles at Stripe, FIS, and Calypso Technology, and began his career in fixed income portfolio management at Olayan Investments and Mellon Capital. Maher holds an MS in Management Science & Engineering from Stanford University.



Omar Kamal

Omar Kamal, PhD, is Partner and Co-founder at B8 Venture Partners, overseeing venture sourcing and founder relationships with a focus on embedded finance; a veteran investor with 20+ years in VC, he was co-Group CEO of a Geneva-based family office until 2015, CIO and founder of a Middle East regional bank, and EY Partner in advisory/consulting, with early investments in Onfido, Threads, Pirate.com, and board/advisory roles at Tifin, CybSafe, and others.



Dr. Fawaz Gerges

Fawaz A. Gerges is Professor of International Relations at LSE, holder of the Emirates Professorship in Contemporary Middle East Studies, and expert on Islamist movements, jihadist groups like Al Qaeda/ISIS, Arab politics, US policy in the Muslim world, and MENA culture/society; previously teaching at Harvard, Columbia, Oxford, and Sarah Lawrence College, and was former Director of LSE Middle East Centre (2010-2013).

# Appendix: Deal Sourcing & Evaluation Methodology

## Methodology

- Outbound sourcing:** Proactive outreach to founders via LinkedIn, internal networks, and ecosystem mapping from primary research/interviews. Leveraging advisors' networks (e.g., Peyman Mestchian, Omar Kamal) for deal referrals and validation.
- Inbound sourcing:** Attend flagship events like GITEX plus regional ones (e.g., LEAP Riyadh, RiseUp Cairo) to meet founders, aiming to channel introductions through team and advisor networks for high-signal opportunities.
- Rigorous evaluation:** Assess teams using academic frameworks (e.g., Gompers et al. metrics on skills/cohesion/integrity) and proprietary scorecards weighting management, opportunity, product/tech; advisory board inputs refine selections.

## Sample Scorecard Used

| Metric                                                                                                                                                                                | Weight      | Score |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|-------|
| <b>Financial Health</b><br>YoY Revenue Growth<br>Price to EBITDA<br>Cash Runway                                                                                                       | 7%          |       |
| <b>Customer Metrics/ Unit Economics</b><br>Net Revenue Retention<br>Life time value/Customer Acquisition Costs<br>Growth in Earnings<br>Customer Retention Rate                       | 15%         |       |
| <b>Operational and Team Metrics</b><br>Team Background and Experience<br>Knowledge of Managers and backgrounds<br>Management Alignment with fund expectations<br>Patent Count/Quality | 20%         |       |
| <b>Risk and Compliance</b><br>Fraud and Detection<br>Concentration Risk<br>Data Protection Metrics<br>Regulatory Compliance                                                           | 15%         |       |
| <b>Growth and Scaleability</b><br>Rule of 40<br>Scaling Capability<br>Serviceable Addressable Market<br>Market Share                                                                  | 18%         |       |
| <b>Exit and Value Creation</b><br>IRR/MOIC<br>Exit Channels<br>Expected TVPI                                                                                                          | 10%         |       |
| <b>Holy Grail Metrics</b><br>Switch Cost Index<br>Platform Dependence<br>Data Network/Pool<br>Ecosystem Positioning                                                                   | 15%         |       |
| <b>SUM</b>                                                                                                                                                                            | <b>100%</b> |       |

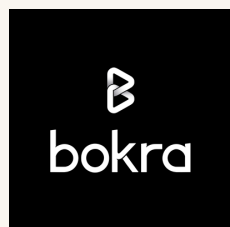
# Appendix: Sample Term Sheet

| Key Clauses | Term sheet requirements                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Rationale                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|-------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Key Clauses | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• For cases whereby a valuation cap is agreed with the convertible note holder, the outstanding balance of the notes will be converted into equity at the next specified financing round at the lower of: (1) valuation cap agreed in the contract or (2) valuation of the common stock in the financing round (excluding a down round)</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Incentivizes investors to invest by guaranteeing shares allocation</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Key Clauses | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Debt outstanding and interest accrued will be settled first in a liquidity event, and then Preferred stockholders will be prioritized before common stockholders for distribution of capital invested (preferred and portion of preferred note that has converted into common equity) at 1 x notional amount invested before common stockholder receive their invested capital.</li> <li>• Once capital invested has been distributed to preferred and common stockholders, any remainder profits in the following order of priority:               <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Preferred stockholders will receive their share of profits in the form of: (1) Interest/coupon accrued on preferred notes outstanding, (2) Portion of preferred note that has been converted into equity will receive the remainder share of profits on a pro-rata basis (based on % ownership of common stock)</li> <li>• Common stockholders will receive the remainder share of profits after preferred stockholders</li> </ul> </li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Protects investors in order of seniority in a liquidity event: debt holders, convertible note holders/preferred stockholders and then common stockholders</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Key Clauses | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• In a down round event, convertible notes and preferred stock will be converted based on a new weighted average price calculated as:               <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• New conversion price = Original conversion price x ((Original shares + New shares) / (Original shares + New shares at New price))</li> <li>• New Shares at New Price is the number of shares that would have been issued if the new price was applied to the original investment.</li> </ul> </li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Protects common stockholders from dilution in a down round. The term sheet requirements drafted are broad-based weighted average which is most common and equitable. Other anti-dilution requirements include:               <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Full Ratchet anti-dilution - preferred notes will convert at the full price of the down round</li> <li>• Narrow-based anti-dilution - considers shares sold in down round and not all outstanding shares</li> </ul> </li> </ul> |
| Key Clauses | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• There will be a board seats allocated to Dune Venture</li> <li>• Board observers can attend Board meetings without a voting right.</li> <li>• Critical decisions specified including issue of new shares, approving budgets, new market/geography entry, exit of the company (sale or IPO) will require unanimous or majority approval from the Board.</li> <li>• The founder(s) will have veto rights over product launches, product expansion, adoption of new technology etc</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Protects founders and investors as both parties have equal Board representation and voting rights on key decisions, whilst the founder has veto right on product decisions so that the company continues to provide products and services based on the founder(s) vision</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |

# Appendix: Primary Research

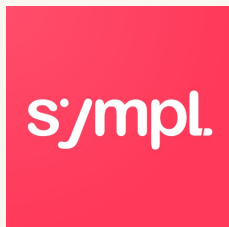
Portion of Firms Interviewed/Emailed & Insights Taken

## Operators & Platforms



Bokra

Payment volume trends &  
SME adoption patterns



Sympl

Cross-border payment  
friction & Reg Gaps



Wafaq

Reg Environment &  
Compliance



Blnk

Credit GAP in Egypt &  
Method to get around  
data gaps



Valu

BNPL Signals MENA



Flend

SME financing  
challenges MENA



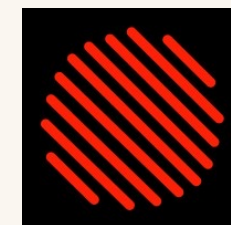
Capifly

SME Financial Data &  
Cultural Navigation



A15 Ventures

Founder Market Fit



Maza Ventures

Cross-Border scaling  
challenges & founder  
market fitting



B8 Ventures

Method to Market Size  
& Team Evaluation

## Institution & Academic



Quantexa

Payment & Credit  
Market data gaps



LSE

Cultural Challenges in  
Scaling cross-border  
business in MENA

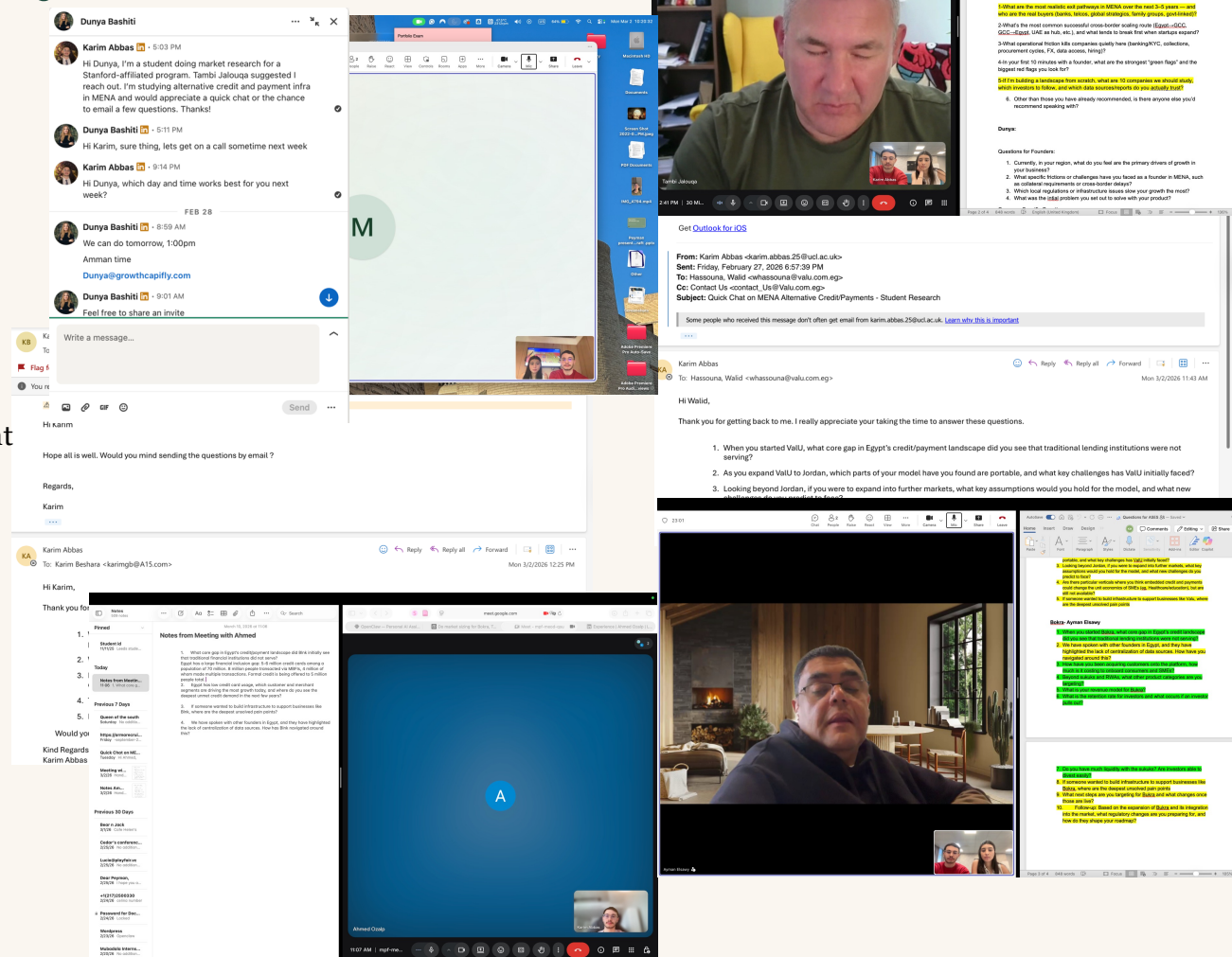
# Appendix: Primary Research

## Platforms Leveraged



## Sample Questions

1. What core gap in Egypt's credit/payment landscape did (xyz firm) initially see that traditional financial institutions did not serve?
2. MENA has low credit card usage which customer and merchant segments are driving the most growth today, and where do you see the deepest unmet credit demand in the next few years?
3. We have spoken with other founders in MENA, and they have highlighted the lack of centralization of data sources. How have you navigated around this?
4. If someone wanted to build infrastructure to support businesses like (xyz firm), where are the deepest unsolved pain points?
5. What operational friction kills fintech companies quietly here (banking/KYC, collections, procurement cycles, FX, data access, hiring)?





# Appendix: Political Risk Assessment Amid Ongoing Events

| Metric                  | DESCRIPTION & DATA                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | EGYPT RATING | EGYPT                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | UAE RATING | UAE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | SAUDI ARABIA RATING | SAUDI ARABIA                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | SOURCES                                                                                                                        |
|-------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Physical Security Risk  | Measures direct exposure of each country to Iranian ballistic missile and drone strikes (Feb–Mar 2026). Iran fired 400+ missiles and ~1,000 drones across all 6 GCC states. US Intelligence classified Egypt as the safest country in the Middle East amid the conflict. UAE suffered the highest density of strikes per sq km of any GCC state.                                                                                                                                                                                  | STABLE       | Not targeted through strikes. US Intelligence reports classified Egypt as safest country in Middle East. Egypt maintained formal neutrality — Sisi offered mediation to all parties.                                                                                                                                                  | HIGH       | 541 drones, 174 ballistic missiles intercepted/struck UAE. Dubai Int'l Airport hit; Jebel Ali Port disrupted (world's 9th busiest, ~\$350B annual throughput). 3 killed, 58 injured. AWS data centre struck — first cloud infrastructure war damage in history.                                                              | HIGH                | Ras Tanura refinery (550K bpd capacity) struck by drones — precautionary shutdown triggered. US Embassy in Riyadh's Diplomatic Quarter hit on Day 3. Saudi Army raised to full alert. MfS authorised military retaliation with US backing.                                                                                                                             | ACLED Mar 2026 Special Issue; JINSA Gulf Situation Assessment; Breaking Defense Mar 2026; Al-Arabiya; The National             |
| Currency / FX Stability | Assesses foreign exchange vulnerability and capital flight risk. Egypt's EGP lost EGP 1.80 vs USD in first 48hrs (→ EGP 49.17/\$), reflecting \$1.12B in foreign capital exits from government debt. UAE (AED) and Saudi Arabia (SAR) are both hard-pegged to the USD, providing structural FX stability. Egypt's FX reserves stood at \$46.7B as of Jan 2026 (CBE), providing a partial buffer.                                                                                                                                  | MEDIUM       | EGP -3.7% in 48hrs; \$1.12B capital outflow from government debt pre/during strikes. EGP reserves at \$46.7B (CBE Jan 2026). Egyptian Stock Exchange declining. EGP already weakened 50%+ since 2022 devaluation — limited further flexibility.                                                                                       | STABLE     | AED hard-pegged to USD at 3.67 — no devaluation risk. UAE sovereign wealth funds (ADIA + Mubadala) hold ~\$1.7T in assets, providing deep buffer. UAE FX reserves at \$238B (IMF 2025).                                                                                                                                      | STABLE              | SAR hard-pegged to USD at 3.75. Saudi FX reserves at \$439B (SAMA Jan 2026) — among world's largest. Aramco revenues (\$121B net income in 2024) provide structural cushion even at \$83/bbl.                                                                                                                                                                          | CBE Egypt FX Reserves Jan 2026; IMF UAE Article IV 2025; SAMA Monthly Statistics Jan 2026; World Bank; Reuters                 |
| Trade & Supply Chain    | Evaluates disruption to international trade flows through key regional chokepoints. Suez Canal handles ~12–15% of global trade; Egypt earns ~\$9–10B annually from transit fees. Since the 2023 Houthi crisis, Maersk, CMA CGM & MSC rerouted via Cape of Good Hope — adding 10–14 days and ~\$1M per voyage. World Bank estimates Egypt's total Suez-related loss at \$10B+ since Jan 2024. Strait of Hormuz (UAE/KSA gateway) handles ~20% of global oil supply; effectively closed Mar 2026.                                   | HIGH         | Suez Canal revenues halted; Cape reroutes = ~\$800M/month loss for Egypt. Suez = 1.5% of GDP and 15% of FX receipts. World Bank estimates \$10B+ in foregone revenue since Jan 2024 (Houthi + Iran conflict combined).                                                                                                                | HIGH       | Jebel Ali Port disrupted (70%+ flights grounded at Dubai Int'l). Dubai handles ~\$400B in annual non-oil trade — 30%+ of UAE GDP. Strait of Hormuz closure directly impacts UAE's re-export economy.                                                                                                                         | HIGH                | Saudi Red Sea ports (Jeddah Islamic Port) less exposed than Gulf ports. However Ras Tanura (Gulf side) shutdown creates domestic supply chain disruption. Saudi non-oil exports = SAR 330B in 2024 (GASTAT) — partially at risk.                                                                                                                                       | World Bank Suez Canal Impact Report 2024; UAE Federal Competitiveness Authority; GASTAT Saudi Trade 2024; IMO; Drewry Shipping |
| Energy Price Contagion  | Captures each country's exposure to energy price shocks from Hormuz closure and regional supply disruption. Brent crude surged to \$83/bbl (+15%) following strikes. Egypt is a net energy importer (since 2022 decline in gas output) — every \$10/bbl rise in Brent costs Egypt ~\$500M in additional import bills annually. Israel-Egypt gas supply deal (~1.1B cu ft/day) was suspended, forcing Egypt to seek expensive LNG spot cargoes. UAE and Saudi Arabia are net exporters — higher oil prices benefit state revenues. | HIGH         | Israel gas supply (~1.1B cu ft/day) halted — Egypt forced onto spot LNG market. Fuel subsidy bill risk: Egypt spent EGP 98B on energy subsidies in FY2024/25. Every \$10/bbl Brent rise = ~\$500M additional import cost (IMF Egypt Article IV 2025). Fuel prices risk rising 60–70% if Hormuz remains closed 60+ days.               | STABLE     | UAE net oil exporter: produces ~3.5M bpd (ADNOC 2024). \$83/bbl Brent adds ~\$10–12B in incremental annual revenue at current output. Domestic fuel subsidies limited — pass-through pricing in place since 2015.                                                                                                            | STABLE              | Saudi Arabia produces ~9.5M bpd (Aramco 2024). Every \$1/bbl Brent rise = ~\$3.5B in additional annual state revenue. At \$83/bbl vs \$72/bbl baseline, KSA gains ~\$38B/year — partially offsetting conflict costs.                                                                                                                                                   | IMF Egypt Article IV 2025; ADNOC Annual Report 2024; Aramco Annual Report 2024; IEA Oil Market Report Mar 2026; EIA            |
| VC / Startup Ecosystem  | Assesses impact on venture capital activity, startup funding, and fintech investment confidence. MENA VC investment reached \$3.2B across 591 deals in 2024 (MAGNITT). UAE accounted for 42% of MENA deal value in 2024. Saudi Arabia is fastest growing VC market in MENA (+67% YoY deal count, 2024). Egypt ranked 3rd in deal volume. GCC sovereign wealth funds deployed \$126B globally in 2025 — capital repatriation risk now elevated.                                                                                    | MEDIUM       | Fintech operations intact — Egypt not physically targeted. CBE maintaining FX flexibility; domestic digital economy insulated. However \$1.12B capital outflow dents investor sentiment. Egyptian startups raised \$361M in 2024 (MAGNITT) — momentum at risk if macro deteriorates.                                                  | HIGH       | AWS data centre in Dubai struck (drone shrapnel) — first cloud infrastructure war damage ever. UAE stock exchange suspended trading. GCC sovereign wealth funds (\$126B deployed in 2025) face capital repatriation pressure. DIFC/ADGM fintech activity severely disrupted. UAE = 42% of MENA VC deal value 2024 (MAGNITT). | MEDIUM              | Vision 2030 projects paused pending security assessment. Tadawul (Saudi stock exchange) declined materially. Saudi VC deal count grew +67% YoY in 2024 — momentum interrupted. NEOM and Diriyah Gate mega-projects on hold. Saudi startups raised \$1.1B in 2024 (MAGNITT).                                                                                            | MAGNITT MENA Venture Report 2024; STV Saudi VC Report 2024; DIFC Activity Report 2024; GCC Sovereign Wealth Lab 2025           |
| Political Stability     | Evaluates domestic political cohesion, government response to external threats, and diplomatic positioning. The 2023 Iran–Saudi normalisation deal (brokered by China) has been effectively torn up following the attacks. Egypt's formal neutrality stance is backed by its role as a key US/Gulf ally and mediator in Gaza ceasefire talks. Trump administration signalled openness to direct Iran negotiations (Mar 2026), creating a ceasefire pathway.                                                                       | STABLE       | Sisi pursuing active neutrality and mediation — offered de-escalation dialogue to all parties. Egypt maintains strong relationships with both US and Gulf states. National crisis room activated; 11M Egyptians in Gulf region protected by task force. US Intelligence rates Egypt as most stable country in region during conflict. | MEDIUM     | UAE threatened retaliation vs. Iran but stopped short of action. 2023 Iran–UAE normalisation talks effectively collapsed. 'Huge trust gap for years' (CNBC analyst, Mar 2026). UAE leveraging US military umbrella (Al-Dhafra Air Base) but domestic political pressure building.                                            | HIGH                | MfS authorised military retaliation with US backing; described strikes as 'cowardly'. Saudi–Iran 2023 normalisation deal effectively torn up. 'Watching and waiting' posture — but full military alert. Trump open to discussions with Iran on behalf of US — potential diplomatic off-ramp. KSA internal stability strong but external posture most hawkish of three. | CNBC Mar 2026; Foreign Policy Mar 2026; Al-Ahram; Mada Masr; IPS Journal; Atlantic Council; The National UAE                   |

Investment Recommendation

Invest

Most insulated; domestic fintech remains viable

Pause

Monitor closely; delay new commitments 60–90 days

Watch Closely

Might benefit from oil, but its efforts to diversify will get harder, might militarily intervene on behalf of US



# Appendix: Egypt Fintech and Investment Landscape

**\$800M+**

VC invested in MENA  
fintechs 2023

**100M+**

Population  
(median age 24)

**35%**

Adults banked  
(65% unbanked)

**#1**

Africa's largest  
startup ecosystem

## REGULATORY CATALYST

- Central Bank of Egypt Fintech Strategy 2022–2026
- EGP 1B Fintech Support Fund (CBE, 2022)
- Regulatory Sandbox launched 2019 — 20+ companies tested
- Open Banking framework enacted 2023
- E-Payment Law No. 18/2019 mandates digital wage payments
- EFSA digital lending framework covers BNPL & alt-credit

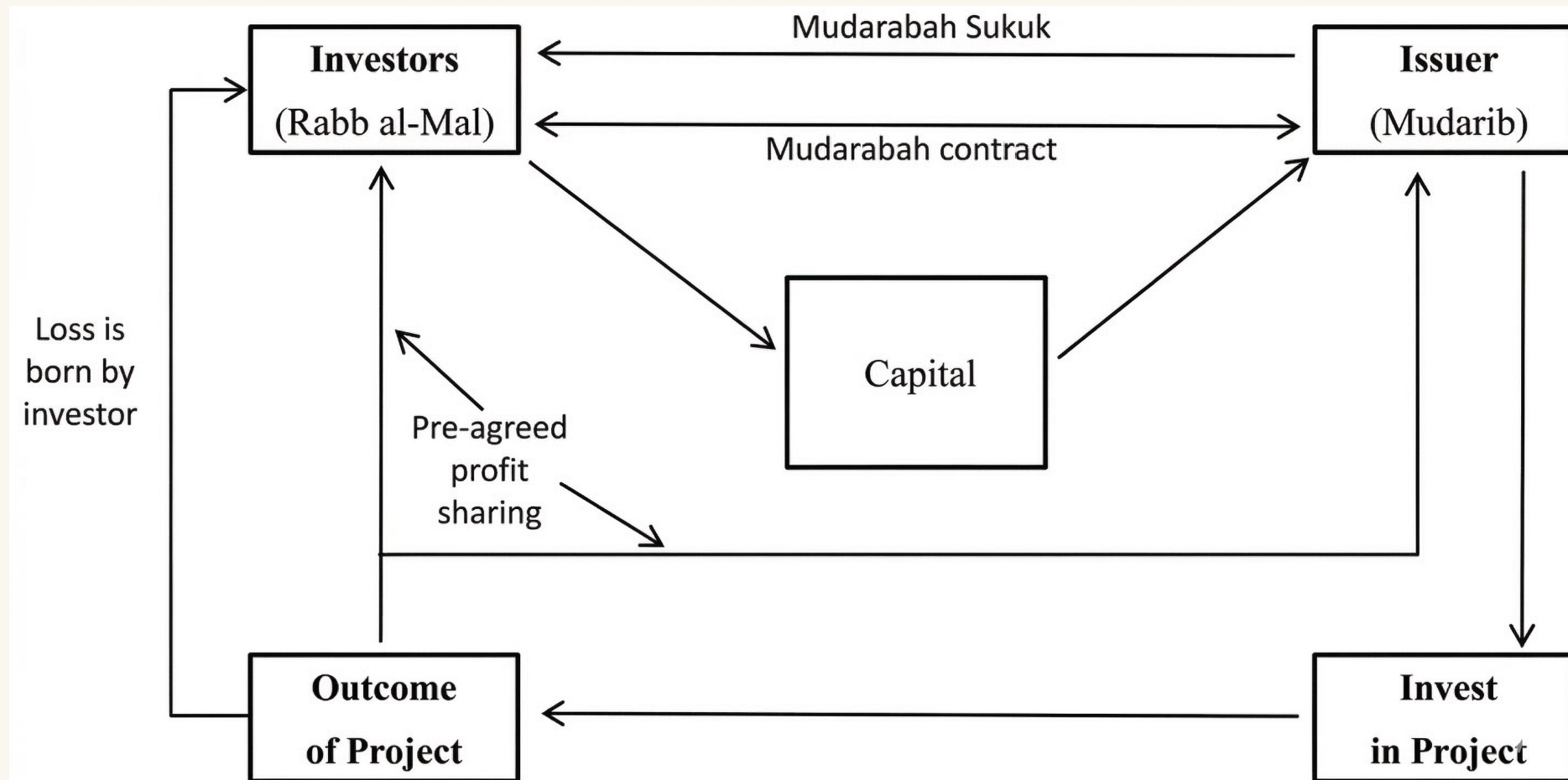
## MARKET OPPORTUNITY

- 6.5M SMEs - only 5–7% formally banked
- \$90B informal economy needs credit access
- Mobile penetration: 95%+ SIM, 60%+ smartphones
- E-commerce CAGR 25%+ (2020–2025)
- Remittances: \$24B (2023) — ripe for disruption
- BNPL market growing 40%+ YoY in MENA

## VC & INVESTOR APPETITE

- Egypt top 3 MENA VC destinations by deal count
- Fintech = 30%+ of all MENA startup deals (2023)
- Flat6Labs, Algebra Ventures, Nclude (\$110M fund)
- IFC, CDC, AfDB are active as anchor LPs
- Notable exits: Fawry IPO 2019 (EGX), valuation \$1B+
- Average seed ticket: \$250K–\$1M; Series A: \$2–10M

## Appendix: How does a Mudarabah Sukuk work?



# Appendix: Investment Comparison

| Dimension                                         | Bokra Primary pick<br>Egypt — Pre-seed / \$4.6M raised                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Stream<br>Saudi Arabia — Seed / \$4M raised                                                                                                                                                                                                  | SaturnX<br>UAE — Seed / \$3M raised                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|---------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Regulatory Moat<br>Licences & barriers to entry   | 16 FRA licences incl. 2024 digital onboarding<br><br>Replicating Egypt's FRA stack takes 3–5 years. No competitor holds equivalent coverage. <b>Moat compounds as Bokra adds products.</b>                                                                                                             | <b>Operating on SAMA (Saudi Central Bank) rails</b><br><br>SAMA compliance is table stakes shared by most Saudi fintech's, <b>not a durable moat.</b>                                                                                        | Stablecoin API: regulatory licences not disclosed, <b>however UAE ecosystem moving to accelerate stablecoins</b> through the 2024 Payment Token Services Regulation (PTSR), licensing multiple stablecoins, including AE Coin, Zand AE, to strengthen its position as a global crypto hub<br><br>Cross-border stablecoin <b>beyond UAE</b> will be a challenge as it relies on connecting multiple countries. |
| Product Breadth<br>Verticals covered & stickiness | <b>B2C savings + B2B SME credit in one platform</b><br><br>USD-linked savings, sukuk issuance, and AI credit scoring form an integrated flywheel. Savers become borrowers; higher LTV per customer than any single-vertical peer.                                                                      | B2B billing and payments automation only<br><br>Single-vertical product. Started as a Edtech-to-SaaS, its expansion might pose challenges as it integrates into new industries.                                                              | B2B cross-border payments (stablecoin API)<br><br>Currently operates as a Gulf-to-South Asia corridor, and expanding to 4 more countries in South Asia(including Indonesia, Pakistan etc.. .                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Team Depth<br>Domain fit & execution risk         | 4-person C-suite · 120+ combined yrs fintech · CEO Ayman Elsaywy: 21 yrs sukuk structuring, finance experience in Egypt and can utilise FRA relationships.<br><b>Execution risk is low</b> , as the team consists of entrepreneurs, local operational and FRA networks, and non-banking finance track. | Ibrahim Aldlaigan (CEO): VC-turned-founder, first-time operator<br><br>STV/SIDF background provides Saudi market insight. Solo founder, no prior exits, young team with limited finance and compliance depth. High key-person concentration. | Mirnas Brescic (CEO): 15+ yrs FX/treasury · Rain, Bitpanda<br>CTO Sanjin Kovačević: 20+ yrs crypto engineering<br><br>Strongest individual founder profile for this product type. Execution risk reflects <b>key-person reliance on Brescic.</b>                                                                                                                                                              |
| Traction<br>Users, volume & proof points          | <b>45,000 users · \$60M sukuk executed · Egypt expansion underway</b><br><br>Sukuk execution requires FRA sign-off, institutional distribution, and redemption infrastructure, <b>strongest operational proof point.</b>                                                                               | <b>40% MoM growth</b> · millions processed · thousands of users<br><br>Plans to expand in Saudi and MENA (risky).                                                                                                                            | <b>\$250M+ volume in 5 months</b> · profitable at launch<br><br>Rapid profitability signals real demand. Stablecoin corridors operate on thin basis-point margins                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Market Sizing and Timing                          | EGP -70% since 2022/ \$46B SME credit gap/ Sharia demand unmet digitally<br><br>Three independent demand drivers converging simultaneously. Currency crisis creates urgent pull for inflation-proof savings. SME credit gap is structural, not cyclical.                                               | 7% of consumer transactions are recurring payments /12.6 bn non-cash transactions in KSA.                                                                                                                                                    | Stablecoin remittance adoption accelerating.. Brescic's network gives genuine first-mover advantage.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |

Sources: Bokra, SaturnX, Stream, Pitchbook, Bloomberg

# Appendix: Bokra

## Problem

# -70%

### Currency Collapse

EGP lost 70% vs USD since 2022. Four devaluations in 24 months decimated savings.

# 36.5%

### Peak Inflation

Annual inflation hit record 36.5% in Jul 2023. EGP cash holdings lost real value instantly.

# \$46 bn

### Financing Gap

Annual financing gap for Egyptian SMEs - millions underserved by formal credit markets.

## Solution

**Bokra** is an Egyptian fintech that helps both SMEs and individuals protect savings and access credit in Egypt's high-inflation, currency-volatile economy.

### Inflation-Proof Savings

USD-linked & commodity-backed savings products that preserve real value against EGP devaluation

### Credit | Alternative SME Finance

Sharia-compliant sukuk & alternative credit scoring to bridge the \$46bn annual financing gap for Egypt's SMEs and underbanked individuals.

### Payments

Digital payment infrastructure enabling MSMEs to collect, transact, and manage cash flow — replacing informal channels.

## Traction Pre-Seed Raised: \$4.6 M, \$58.9M

**Purpose:** To launch their app, expand investment products, and scale operations across MENA, focusing on asset-backed securities for retail and SME investors.

**Lead Investors:** DisrupTech Ventures and SS Capital.

Both are regional investors; (DisrupTech are Egypt Based), (SS Capital are UAE based) growing interest from MENA-focused VC and impact funds.

# \$60M

### Sukuk Arranged

Bokra successfully issued its first Sharia-compliant sukuk (Islamic bond) valued at EGP 3 billion (approximately \$58.9 million) to support SME's

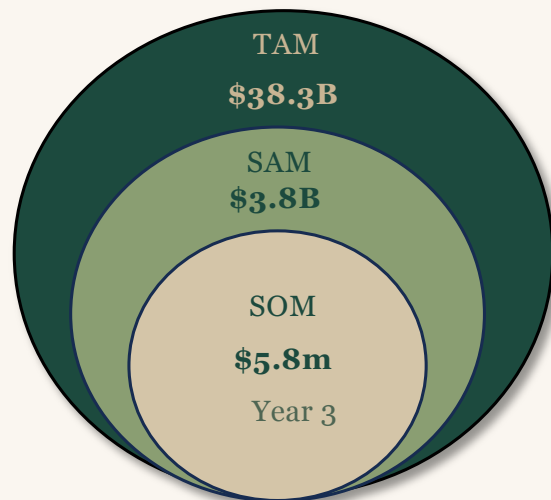
# 16

### Licenses Approved from FTA

The Bokra Real Estate Investment Fund and Bokra Mineral Investment Fund, along with licenses for offering, managing, and promoting investment fund certificates. This enables them to provide digital investment options, with a 2024 license for digital onboarding.

# Appendix: Market Analysis Logic

## Top Down-Market Sizing



|             |                                                                                                                                                     |
|-------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| TAM Blended | \$225B MENA credit gap, \$13.2B representing the Islamic SME credit gap in MENA, \$3.3B gap in Egypt + \$35B retail savings/investment gap in Egypt |
| SAM Blended | 10% of the gap is addressable via digital native solutions                                                                                          |
| SOM Blended | Assuming 5% market capture in 3 years, with a take rate of 3%                                                                                       |

## Top-Down Assumptions & Logic

- Regional MSME credit TAM (MENA)**  
IFC and the World Bank estimate MENA's MSME finance gap at 210–240B USD; we use the midpoint of 225B USD as the regional MSME credit TAM.
- Alternative/Sharia-compliant portion**  
IFC identifies a 13.2B USD gap for Islamic SME product, with 25% of the market attributable to Egypt (\$3.3B) . The Egypt retail/investments sector was valued at \$35 billion, hence a blended TAM of \$38.3B
- Digital-addressable SAM for Egypt**  
**SAM:** Of the 35 billion investment gap and \$3.3B credit gap, only 8-10% is currently addressable via digital financial solutions. Hence, this narrows the SAM down to \$3.83B
- Bokra 3-year SOM:** Assuming a 5% market capture and a blended take rate of 3 %, we get a SOM of \$5.75 million

| Product                      | Fee Rate                               | Details/Benchmark              |
|------------------------------|----------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| Credit (Murabaha/ SME loans) | 2-5% markup/profit share annually      | Not interest; Sharia-compliant |
| Savings/Investments          | 0.5-1.5% AUM fee                       | Sharia funds                   |
| Blended Take Rate            | 2.5% (conservative); 3.5% (aggressive) | e.g., Tabby/Tamara 4.25% BNPL  |

# Appendix: Market Analysis Logic

## Bottom-up Market Sizing

### 1. Market

- The B2B Market:** Egypt is home to approximately 2.5 million SMEs. About 11% of these fall strictly into the "small to medium" (non-micro) categories. This gives Bokra an addressable pool of roughly 275,000 formalized businesses.
- The B2C Market:** Bokra's competitor, Thndr, has already validated retail demand by activating over 431,000 mutual fund investors. We are modeling for Bokra to capture just 50,000 active retail users by Year 3. They have over 100k google play downloads currently
- SME Ticket Sizes:** The standard Murabaha SME loan size in Egypt typically ranges from EGP 200,000 to EGP 5 million. An assumed average ticket size of \$40,000 (approx. EGP 2 million) sits between.

| Revenue Stream              | Year 3 Target Metric      | Average Volume / Ticket | Total Managed Volume | Applied Fee Rate  | Projected Revenue |
|-----------------------------|---------------------------|-------------------------|----------------------|-------------------|-------------------|
| Credit (Murabaha / SME)     | 1,200 SME Borrowers       | \$40,000 per loan       | \$48.00 Million      | 3.50% (Midpoint)  | \$1.68 Million    |
| Savings & Investments (AUM) | 800 SMEs + 50k Retail     | Blended AUM             | \$220.00 Million     | 1.00% (Midpoint)  | \$2.20 Million    |
| Platform Transactions       | 70,000 Total Active Users | \$1,000 annual volume   | \$70.00 Million      | 2.50% (Take Rate) | \$1.75 Million    |
| Total Bottom-Up SOM         |                           |                         |                      |                   | \$5.63 Million    |

Sources: Pitchbook, Worldbank, Thndr, Mordor Intelligence, Google Play Store, OECD



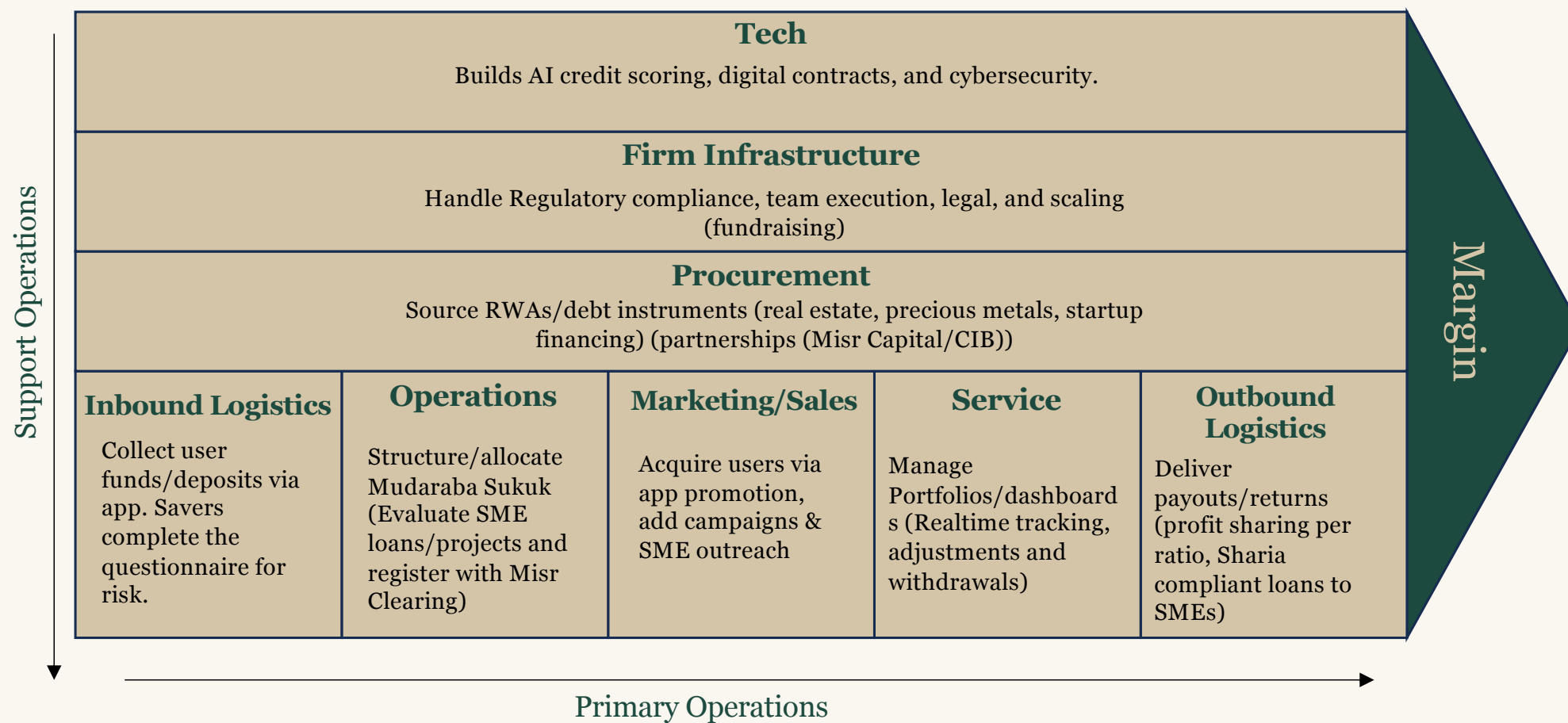
# Appendix: Competitor Framework

| Competitor           | Stage/Funding                 | Country       | Core Product                                | Core Customers                     | Key Differentiator                                              |
|----------------------|-------------------------------|---------------|---------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Bokra</b>         | Pre-seed / \$4.6M             | Egypt         | Sharia savings / sukuk / real estate        | Retail + SMEs                      | Integrated halal asset classes in one app                       |
| <b>Thndr</b>         | Series B+ / \$38M total       | Egypt         | Digital brokerage / funds / gold            | Young retail investors             | Mobile-first stock & fund trading                               |
| <b>Fawry Yawmy</b>   | Mature / Fawry \$150M+        | Egypt         | Daily-return money market fund              | Mass market small savers           | Leverages Fawry's vast payment network                          |
| <b>Sukuk Capital</b> | Established / N/A             | KSA           | Digital sukuk issuance / investing          | Retail + inst. sukuk investors     | End-to-end sukuk origination & distribution                     |
| <b>Wahed Invest</b>  | Growth / \$50M+ total         | USA / KSA hub | Sharia-compliant robo-advisory & portfolios | Muslim retail investors globally   | First global halal robo-advisor; MENA HQ in Riyadh              |
| <b>Beehive</b>       | Mature / e& enterprise-backed | UAE           | P2P digital SME lending (Sharia option)     | UAE SMEs + retail investors        | First DFSA-regulated P2P lender in MENA                         |
| <b>Funding Souq</b>  | Early Growth / \$2.5M seed    | UAE / KSA     | Sharia-compliant SME crowdlending           | SMEs + retail/inst. debt investors | Licensed by Saudi Central Bank; targets KSA's 400B+ SAR SME gap |

# Appendix: Bokra GTM Strategy

| Segment                         | Who                                                     | Product hook                                                                                | Current GTM motion                                                                                                                           | Recommended next moves                                                                                                                                         |
|---------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Retail banked</b>            | Existing bank customers in Cairo & Alexandria           | Higher-yield, Sharia-compliant savings into gold, real estate, sukuk from low ticket sizes. | Acquire through banks and digital marketing; position as “goal-based savings with real assets, better rates than deposits.” Online marketing | Co-branded campaigns with Islamic bank windows; goal-based journeys (education, Hajj, retirement); referral loops and family/group saving.                     |
| <b>Retail /underbanked</b>      | Cash-based mass market, gig workers, youth              | Simple halal saving wallet with small, regular contributions into asset-backed portfolios.  | Early-stage; mainly spillover from city expansion (Cairo, Alexandria). Traditional Marketing strategies.                                     | Agent & merchant cash-in/out, mosque & community financial-literacy campaigns, embedded savings in gig apps where % of earnings auto-saved. Financial Literacy |
| <b>SME borrowers</b>            | Micro & small businesses; gig drivers; asset-heavy SMEs | Access to sukuk- or revenue-based financing via Business Portal and partner programs.       | Anchor verticals: Aman microfinance portfolios, 6k-vehicle program with Rehla/Nissan for drivers.                                            | Deepen 2-3 verticals (transport, healthcare, small retail); fast, template-based structures in the Portal; bundle financing with a Bokra SME savings wallet.   |
| <b>Institutions / platforms</b> | MFIs, leasing consortiums                               | Infrastructure to securitize portfolios (sukuk) and distribute to investors.                | Lead-arranger role in Aman sukuk; partnerships with Aman Holding, Rehla Rides etc.                                                           | “Non-bank lender enablement” pitch: white-label funding rails; APIs/Portal for repeated issuances; expand to more platforms in adjacent sectors.               |

# Appendix: Value Chain Analysis



# Appendix: Valuation

## Scorecard Method

Based on their \$4.6M raise in 2024, if they sold 33.3% of the company (standard at pre-seed in region), their post-money valuation was \$ 13.8M. The industry average seed stage valuation is \$22m

| Startup  | Description                 | Stage/Funding | Est. Pre-Money | Location |
|----------|-----------------------------|---------------|----------------|----------|
| Thndr    | Digital investing platform  | Seed \$15.7M+ | \$20M          | Egypt    |
| Nowpay   | Earned wage access          | Seed \$2.1M   | \$10M          | Egypt    |
| FlapKap  | Revenue-based e-com finance | Seed \$3.6M   | \$15M          | MENA     |
| CoinMENA | Crypto platform             | Seed \$9.5M   | \$40M          | Bahrain  |
| Nqoodlet | SME financial OS            | Seed \$3M     | \$12M          | Saudi    |
| Stitch   | Fintech infrastructure APIs | Seed \$10M    | \$35M          | Saudi    |
| Median   |                             | \$6.55M       | \$17.5M        |          |

| Factor              | Weight | Score (0-2) | Weighted Contribution | Notes                        |
|---------------------|--------|-------------|-----------------------|------------------------------|
| Management          | 30%    | 1.33x       | 0.40x                 | Strong track record          |
| Opportunity Size    | 25%    | 1.56x       | 0.39x                 | Egypt inflation hedge demand |
| Product/Tech        | 15%    | 1.33x       | 0.20x                 | SUKUK proprietary            |
| Competitive Env.    | 10%    | 1.22x       | 0.12x                 | Niche advantage              |
| GTM Strategy        | 10%    | 1.67x       | 0.17x                 | EGP debt partner trust       |
| FRA License (Other) | 10%    | 1.67x       | 0.17x                 | Very rare in MENA fintech    |
| Total Adjustment    | 100%   | -           | 1.45                  | Sum of weighted scores       |

Pre-money Valuation: 17.5M x 1.45= \$25.40M

Sources: Pitchbook, Empower Africa

# Appendix: Valuation, VC Method

## Bottom-up Revenue Projection

| Revenue Stream                | Projected Year 5 Volume | Applied Fee Rate (From Image)        | Projected Annual Revenue |
|-------------------------------|-------------------------|--------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Credit (Murabaha / SME loans) | \$500.0 Million         | 3.50% (Midpoint of 2-5% markup)      | \$17.50 Million          |
| Savings / Investments         | \$1.50 Billion (AUM)    | 1.00% (Midpoint of 0.5-1.5% AUM fee) | \$15.00 Million          |
| Platform Transactions         | \$140.0 Million         | 2.50% (Conservative BNPL take rate)  | \$3.50 Million           |
| Total Year 5 Revenue          |                         |                                      | \$36.00 Million          |

## Sensitivity Table

| Scenario | Exit (TV) | Post-Money | Pre-Money | Ownership |
|----------|-----------|------------|-----------|-----------|
| Downside | \$202.05m | \$16.84m   | \$10.34m  | 7.13%     |
| Base     | \$500m    | \$33.68m   | \$27.18m  | 3.56%     |
| Upside   | \$606.15m | \$50.51m   | \$44.01m  | 2.38%     |

Sources: Pitchbook, Calculates, TheStartupScene, EmpowerAfrica, Allied Ventures

| VC Method                | Metric            | Justification                                                                                                        |
|--------------------------|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Projected Year 5 Revenue | \$36.0M           | Scaled from the \$5.75M Year 3 SOM (derived from the \$3.83B SAM and 5% market capture).                             |
| Exit Multiple            | 11.25x EV/Revenue | Exit multiple, sitting below the 12.3x industry average.                                                             |
| Terminal Value (Year 5)  | \$404.1M          | Calculated as Year 5 Revenue (\$36M) multiplied by the 11.25x Exit Multiple.                                         |
| Expected ROI Hurdle      | 12x               | Institutional-grade hurdle appropriately reflecting the risk profile of asset-backed Sharia funds. (Allied Ventures) |
| Post-Money Valuation     | \$33.68M          | Calculated as Terminal Value (\$404.1M) divided by the 12x ROI requirement.                                          |
| Total Round Size         | \$6.50M           | Anticipated total syndicate round size.                                                                              |
| VC Pre-Money Valuation   | \$27.18M          | Calculated as Post-Money Valuation (\$33.68M) minus the Total Round Size (\$6.50M).                                  |

# Appendix: Valuation

## MENA Seed Fintech Valuation Benchmarks

| Market/Segment              | Median Pre-Money  | Mean Pre-Money      | Top Quartile       |
|-----------------------------|-------------------|---------------------|--------------------|
| MENA Overall Seed           | \$3.7M            | \$6-8M              | \$10-12M           |
| UAE/GCC Fintech Seed        | \$8-11M           | \$11.6M             | \$15M+             |
| Egypt Fintech Pre-Seed/Seed | \$4-6M (pre-seed) | \$10-15M (traction) | \$20M+ (hot deals) |

### Valuation Justification

| Factor          | Bokra Premium          | MENA Median  |
|-----------------|------------------------|--------------|
| Traction        | \$60M sukuk issued     | Minimal      |
| Regulatory Moat | 16 FRA licenses        | Sandbox only |
| Market Timing   | EGP crisis tailwind    | Neutral      |
| Team            | Elsawy 21yrs sukuk exp | Generalists  |
| Blended Result  | \$26.76M               | \$6-12M      |

### Blended Valuation Range

| Method    | Weight | Pre-Money Valuation |
|-----------|--------|---------------------|
| Scorecard | 20%    | \$25.3M             |
| VC Method | 80%    | \$27.18M            |
| Blended   | 100%   | \$26.76M            |

Sources: Pitchbook, TheStartupScene, EmpowerAfrica, Wallstreetprep, Clearworld

# SaturnX

## Problem

# \$131.5B

### GCC Outbound Remittances (2023)

GCC is the world's single largest remittance source. 38M+ migrant workers send earnings home through costly, slow bank channels with no real-time visibility. Stablecoin rails offer instant settlement at <0.5% cost, but no unified API infrastructure.

# 5.9%

### Average Transfer Cost

Versus G20 target of 3%. Traditional banks capture the spread through FX markups, correspondent fees, and settlement delays, a structural rent that stablecoin infrastructure eliminates.

## Solution

**SaturnX** is a UAE based stablecoin-based payments infrastructure provider based in UAE connecting an international network of regulated partners to enable faster, cheaper cross-border value transfer through a single universal API.

### Universal Conversion Layer

Accept fiat or stablecoins (USDT/USDC), convert across chains, disburse in local currencies, and fund global bank accounts, all through one REST API. Removes the need to maintain multiple banking relationships per corridor.

### API Integration

Real-time webhooks, live FX quotes, and a unified dashboard for balance tracking, payouts, and compliance reporting across all corridors simultaneously.

### Payments

Digital payment infrastructure enabling MSMEs to collect, transact, and manage cash flow — replacing informal channels.

## Traction Seed Raised: 3 mn

**Purpose:** Build and scale a stablecoin API infrastructure layer connecting regulated corridor partners across GCC, Asia, Africa, Europe and Latin America, enabling PSPs, fintechs, FIs and enterprises to move money instantly at sub-1% cost.

**Lead Investors:** White Star Capital, a global multi-stage technology investment firm (aligns with product mission).

# \$250M

 Transaction volume

SaturnX has reported processing over \$250 million in transaction volume within its **first five months** of operation

# 4+

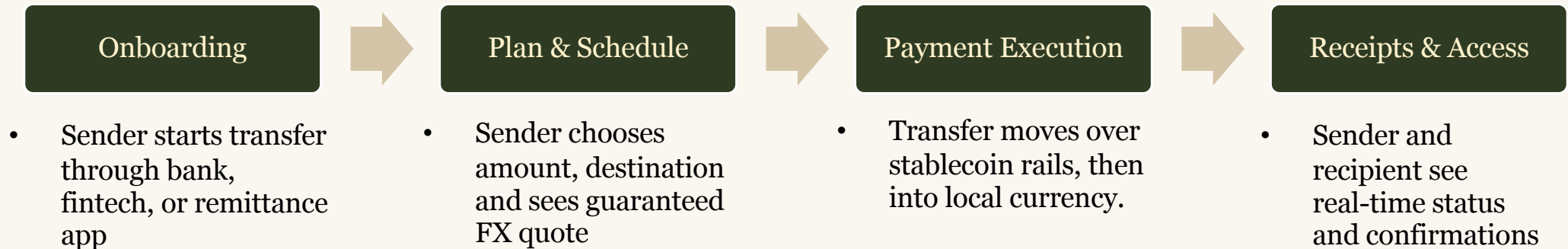
## New Markets for Expansion

Following its initial success, SaturnX is expanding its infrastructure into 4 new strategic markets: Indonesia, Bangladesh, Pakistan, and the Philippines, operating as a key payment corridor between the Gulf Region and South Asia



# SaturnX Technology

## Cross-Border Payment Flow – End User

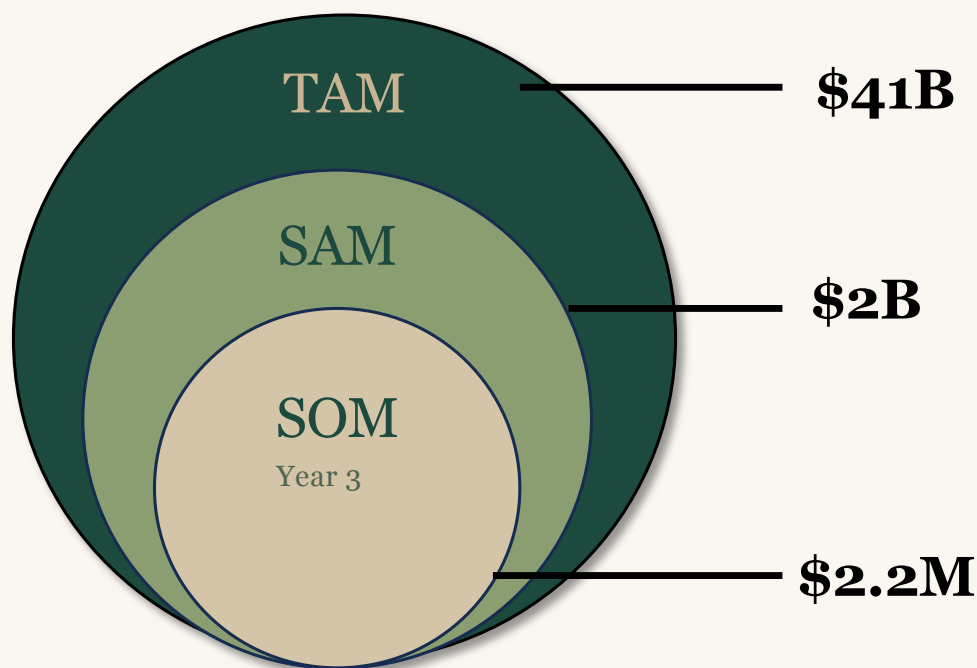


## Partner Platform Flow – B2B Clients



# Appendix: Market Analysis

## Top Down-Market Sizing



**TAM:** The MENA cross border payment market was estimated at between \$100-200 billion annually. The UAE outbound cross-border payments market was valued at 41B between 2023-2025. Saturn X's primary focus is on the UAE South Asia market, which accounts for around \$10B USD annually.

**SAM:** Recent PwC market reports have highlighted that around 20% of B2B transactions in this corridor between the UAE and South Asia are addressable via stablecoins, resulting in a \$2 billion SAM. The UAE is an early adopter of the technology, and the regulations align with expanding access to it.

**SOM:** Saturn X has had significant traction processing over \$250 million in transactions in 2025. Which is already 12.5% capture of the market, we project that by 2029 they will hit a capture of \$440 million, a market capture of 22%, assuming a fee rate of 0.5%, giving a SOM of \$2.2 million. The 0.5% is in line with charges on transactions in the sector

# Appendix: Competitor Framework

| Competitor             | Stage / Funding                                       | Country             | Core Product                                             | Core Customers                                          | Key Differentiator                                                                          |
|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Saturn X</b>        | Seed / \$3M (2025)                                    | UAE (Dubai)         | Stablecoin payment infrastructure API                    | B2B money transmitters, corporates, financial platforms | Enterprise-grade stablecoin rails for cross-border payments; Gulf-South Asia corridor focus |
| <b>Tabby</b>           | Unicorn / Series D \$1.5B valuation, \$950M+ raised   | UAE/KSA (Riyadh HQ) | BNPL + Tabby Card + marketplace                          | 10M+ retail consumers, 30,000+ merchants                | MENA's first fintech unicorn; \$6B+ annual transaction volume; planned Saudi IPO            |
| <b>Tamara</b>          | Unicorn / \$1B valuation, \$500M equity + \$400M debt | KSA (Riyadh)        | BNPL + shopping + banking services                       | 10M+ users, 30,000+ merchants (GCC)                     | First Saudi fintech unicorn; Shariah-compliant \$2.4B financing facility (2025)             |
| <b>MNT-Halan</b>       | Unicorn / \$1B+ valuation, \$400M+ raised             | Egypt (Cairo)       | Financial super-app: BNPL, wallets, microloans, payments | Unbanked/underbanked mass market Egypt                  | Egypt's first private fintech unicorn; \$2B+ loans disbursed; IFC-backed                    |
| <b>CredibleX</b>       | Seed / \$5.5M equity + \$200M debt facility           | UAE (Abu Dhabi)     | Embedded SME lending API/platform                        | 100,000+ SMEs via 35+ distribution partners             | ADGM-licensed; AED 100M disbursed at launch; embedded into Network Int'l, DMCC, etc.        |
| <b>Abwab.ai</b>        | Early stage / Backed by global investors              | KSA (Riyadh)        | AI-powered credit underwriting for SME lending           | Banks, NBFIs, fintech lenders (B2B SaaS)                | First Saudi-built AI credit engine; targets \$250B MENA SME financing gap                   |
| <b>Cashew Payments</b> | Growth / Undisclosed                                  | UAE                 | BNPL installment payments                                | Retail consumers, merchants (retail to travel)          | Seamless interest-free installments across diverse verticals                                |
| <b>Shahry</b>          | Early Growth / Undisclosed                            | Egypt               | BNPL interest-free installment plans                     | Underserved online shoppers                             | User-friendly platform targeting underbanked segments                                       |

# Appendix: SaturnX Team

| Name                | Title         | Background                            | Strength                                    |
|---------------------|---------------|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| Mirnas Brescic, CFA | Founder & CEO | FX, Treasury & Digital Assets Veteran | Stablecoin Infrastructure & Payments Vision |
| Sanjin Kovačević    | CTO           | Serial Tech & Engineering Leader      | Crypto Exchange & Payments Architecture     |



## Team Assessment:

| Metric                      | Evaluation Criteria                              | Assessment Basis                                                                                                                                                              | Score (1–5) |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| Skills                      | Founder Alignment with Company Needs             | Founder/CEO Mirnas Brescic's 15+ years in FX, treasury, and digital assets (Rain, Bitpanda, IAEA) directly align with stablecoin payment rails for Gulf-South Asia corridors. | 5           |
| Cohesion                    | Role clarity across team                         | Clear roles: Brescic (CEO/vision), Sanjin Kovačević (CTO/tech, 20+ years engineering/crypto exchanges), Faizan Asdar Ahmad (Growth/Partnerships, Aquanow/Rain regulatory)     | 4           |
| Integrity & Trustworthiness | Alignment with investor expectations             | Strong investor alignment via \$3M seed from White Star Capital; compliant infrastructure with on-chain monitoring/KYB; rapid profitability builds trust.                     | 5           |
| Execution Risk              | Dependence on original Founder (Key Person Risk) | Key-person reliance on Brescic for domain expertise; solid tech/growth support but young team (founded 2024) tempers risk.                                                    | 3           |
| Motivation & Commitment     | Willingness & Ability to accept opportunity cost | Achieved profitability/\$250M volume in 5 months post-2024 founding; leaders left high-profile roles (e.g., Faizan at Aquanow) for this venture.                              | 5           |
| Complementarity             | Complementary Team Skill Set                     | Tech depth (Sanjin), regulatory/partnerships (Faizan), strategy/exits (advisor Azem Husrep/Monri acquired); covers stablecoin infra needs.                                    | 4           |
| Experience                  | Prior startup / Exit Experience                  | Strong startups: Azem advisor (Monri Payments acquired by Payten); Sanjin (crypto exchanges); prior roles at unicorns (Rain, Aquanow/Fast 50)—but core team no direct exits   | 4           |

Sources: SaturnX, Gompers et al., 2020, Pitchbook, LinkedIn

# Appendix: SaturnX Risk Analysis

| Risk Category     | Description & Data                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Current Risk                                                                         | Mitigation Strategy                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Future Risk                                                                                         |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Regulatory        | UAE VARA issued stablecoin guidance in 2024 requiring reserve backing & licensing; CBUAE's Payment Token Services Regulation (Jan 2024) mandates AED-backed or UAE-approved stablecoins only for domestic payments. USDT/USDC usage in B2B corridors sits in grey zone. SaturnX holds no disclosed UAE payment license as of seed round (Jun 2025). FATF grey-listed UAE until 2024 exit — compliance obligations still heightened.                                                                                     | Medium<br>(no public license disclosed; VARA framework applies)                      | Partner with licensed entities for regulatory coverage; apply for VARA VASP license; engage CBUAE for Payment Token compliance pathway; legal counsel for each corridor jurisdiction.                                                      | High<br>(VARA enforcement ramp + SE Asia multi-jurisdiction adds complexity)                        |
| Data / Compliance | Stablecoin transactions carry AML/CFT risk — FATF flagged virtual asset corridors as high-risk. UAE Federal Decree-Law No. 45/2021 (Data Protection) applies to customer KYC data. Pre-funded liquidity pools require proof-of-reserves reporting. SE Asia expansion adds PDPA (Thailand), PDP (Philippines), OJK (Indonesia) obligations. Fines under UAE AML framework up to AED 1M per breach. Cross-border data transfer rules differ per market.                                                                   | Medium<br>(early-stage; data governance frameworks not yet publicly disclosed)       | Deploy bank-grade AML/KYC stack (Chainalysis or Elliptic for on-chain monitoring); ISO 27001 certification roadmap; data residency compliance per corridor; dedicated compliance officer pre-Series A.                                     | High<br>(SE Asia multi-jurisdiction enforcement + VARA data rules tighten in 2026)                  |
| Market Adoption   | Target B2B clients (money transmitters, fintechs) are conservative — slow to migrate from SWIFT/correspondent banking. GCC–South Asia corridor processes ~\$40B+ in annual remittances (World Bank 2024); stablecoin share <2% today. \$250M in 5 months = strong early signal but majority likely from a small number of institutional clients. Enterprise sales cycles: 3–9 months. Competitor Rails: Ripple/ODL, Mastercard Move, Nium.                                                                              | Medium<br>(~\$250M volume in 5mo; concentrated client base likely)                   | Diversify corridor client base; build white-label API with self-serve onboarding; attend Seamless Middle East & Singapore FinTech Festival for enterprise pipeline; publish transaction transparency reports to build trust.               | Medium<br>(stablecoin B2B adoption growing ~35% YoY globally per BCG 2025)                          |
| Sales Execution   | Single-founder company at seed stage; sales infrastructure underdeveloped. B2B enterprise deals require dedicated sales engineers and legal teams. SE Asia expansion requires local market knowledge — Philippines, Bangladesh, Indonesia each have distinct payment operator landscapes. Liquidity pool pre-funding requires significant working capital (\$5–20M per corridor). Geopolitical risk (Iran conflict, Mar 2026) disrupts UAE operations — airport/port strikes create short-term client uncertainty.      | Medium<br>(seed-stage; execution risk elevated given geopolitical context Mar 2026)  | Use seed capital (\$3M) to hire VP Sales & country leads in SE Asia; establish credit facility with liquidity providers; activate contingency plan for UAE operational disruption; build redundant payment rails outside UAE.              | High<br>(Series A hiring velocity vs. market window is critical path)                               |
| Scalability       | Pre-funded liquidity pool model requires capital to scale each new corridor — capital-intensive vs. a pure software model. Each new market needs licensed local partner. Smart contract risk: protocol bugs or oracle manipulation could expose liquidity. FX volatility between stablecoin and local fiat affects payout accuracy. Global stablecoin market cap: \$230B (Mar 2026, CoinGecko) — but institutional DeFi is <5% of this.                                                                                 | High<br>(Regulation differences in various countries)                                | Partner with market makers for liquidity efficiency; use automated FX hedging; formal smart contract audits (CertiK/Hacken); modular API architecture for corridor replication; raise Series A with explicit liquidity facility component. | Very High<br>(cross-border regulatory fragmentation + capital needs escalate with corridor count)   |
| Tech              | API-first infrastructure is exposed to DDoS, smart contract exploits, and private key compromise. In 2024, \$2.2B was stolen from DeFi protocols globally (Chainalysis 2025). Real-time FX aggregation introduces latency and price manipulation risk. Dependence on blockchain node uptime (Ethereum, TRON, Solana) — each with 99.9%+ but not 100% uptime. AWS Dubai data centre was struck by drone shrapnel (Mar 2026) — cloud redundancy now critical. No disclosed SOC2 or ISO 27001 certification at seed stage. | High<br>(early; limited attack surface; \$250M processed without disclosed incident) | Multi-cloud deployment (AWS + Azure + GCP); hardware security modules (HSMs) for key management; third-party smart contract audit; real-time transaction monitoring; bug bounty programme; pursue SOC2 Type II pre-Series A.               | High<br>(attack surface scales with volume; AWS Dubai strike (Mar 2026) raises infrastructure risk) |

Sources: SaturnX, White Star Capital, CBUAE, World Bank Remittances, Chainalysis, BCG, CoinGecko Stablecoin Market Data, FATF UAE UAE Federal Decree-Law No.45/2021 FinTech Global, WAYA, Jane's Infrastructure Intelligence

# Appendix: Stream

## Problem

7%

### Digital Recurring Payments

Only 7% of consumer transactions for recurring payments (tuition, rent, subscriptions) are digital, the vast majority still handled through manual or semi-manual processes.

79%

### Of Retail Payments are Digital

Electronic payments hit 79% of total retail in Saudi Arabia, highlighting a massive structural gap in recurring B2B flows

\$12.6 bn

### Non-Cash Transactions in KSA (2024)

## Solution

**Stream** payment is a Saudi B2B payments platform managing the full lifecycle, enabling businesses to issue branded invoices, schedule flexible payments, and reconcile transactions through local rails.

### Recurring Payment Automation

App-free branded invoices, flexible schedules, and seamless reconciliation, replacing manual, error-prone processes for schools, SaaS, and other verticals.

### B2B Payment Infrastructure

Built on local Saudi rails (SAMA ecosystem), enabling compliance, low-cost transactions, and tight integration with business workflows.

### Expansion

Initially focused on early childhood education, Stream has since scaled to serve school networks, SaaS companies, and broader business verticals, with a 2024 digital onboarding license.

## Traction Seed Raised: 4 mn

**Purpose:** To strengthen Stream's position as a leading B2B payments enabler in MENA, advancing product development, compliance, and user experience while onboarding thousands more businesses.

**Lead Investor:** Outliers VC. **Key Investors:** BYLD Ventures, and angel investor Abdullah Elyas (Co-founder of Careem).

40%

Month-on-month payment volume growth

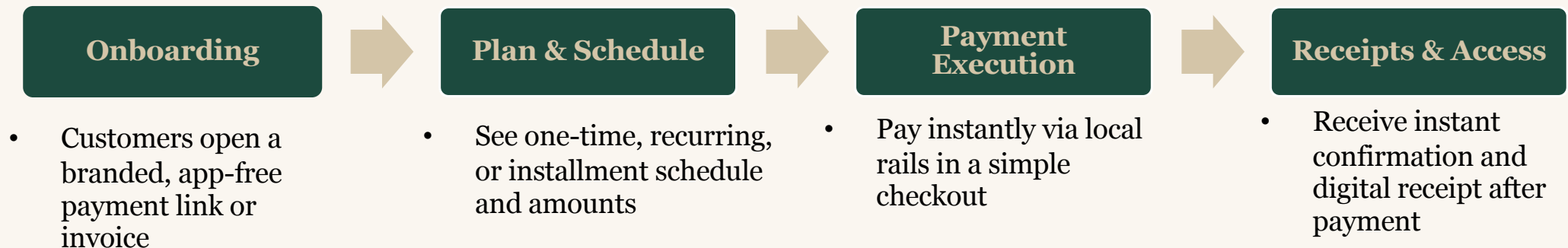
### Notable Clients

Flow MENA · Riyadh Schools Football Academy · Artificial Intelligence Association · School Networks · SaaS Companies

Capital deployed to advance engineering, compliance, payment capabilities and UX supporting its rapidly growing subscriber base with intelligent financial workflow automation.

# Technology

## Business Payment Flow – Payers



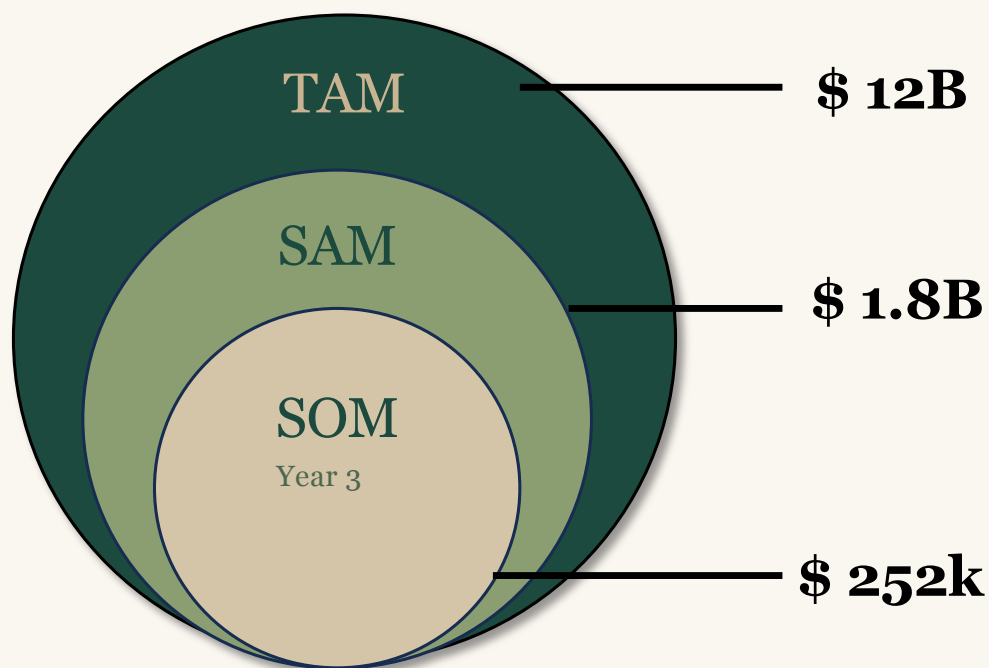
## Business Platform Flow – Merchants





# Appendix: Market Analysis

## Top Down-Market Sizing



**TAM:** Stream targets the B2B payments and billing market, valued at USD 77.9 billion in MENA in 2025. The Saudi Market accounts for USD 12 billion

**SAM:** Research highlights that between 10-20% of B2B flows are recurring, taking the midpoint of 15%, we get a realistic Saudi SAM of USD 1.8 billion.

**SOM:** Realistic market capture of 4% in 3 years' time, provides a SOM of USD 72 million. We assume that Stream is charging a fee of between 30-40 basis points per transaction, hence this gives an estimate of USD 252k *statement here]*

# Appendix: Competitor Framework

| Competitor          | Stage/Funding      | Country      | Core Product                               | Core Customers              | Key Differentiator                                             |
|---------------------|--------------------|--------------|--------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Stream</b>       | Seed / \$4M        | Saudi Arabia | Automated B2B billing & recurring payments | SMEs (education, SaaS)      | End-to-end lifecycle automation (scheduling to reconciliation) |
| <b>obill</b>        | Established / N/A  | Saudi Arabia | ZATCA-compliant e-invoicing                | Saudi SMEs                  | WhatsApp-integrated invoicing + accounting                     |
| <b>Qoyod</b>        | Mature / N/A       | Saudi Arabia | Accounting + e-invoicing                   | Saudi businesses            | Inventory tracking + financial reporting                       |
| <b>DafePay</b>      | Growth / N/A       | Qatar        | B2B digital commerce (bills, vouchers)     | MENA cross-border merchants | AI-powered multi-service platform                              |
| <b>Tap Payments</b> | Series B+ / \$60M+ | Bahrain/UAE  | Online payment gateway                     | MENA e-commerce/SMEs        | Fast merchant onboarding + local methods                       |
| <b>PayTabs</b>      | Mature / \$20M+    | Saudi/UAE    | Payment gateway + orchestration            | Enterprises/fintechs        | Super App for e-com/govt payments                              |
| <b>HyperPay</b>     | Established / N/A  | Saudi Arabia | E-payment gateway                          | MENA merchants              | Recurring payments + tokenization                              |

# Appendix: Team (Stream)



| Name              | Title         | Background                 | Strength                           |
|-------------------|---------------|----------------------------|------------------------------------|
| Ibrahim Aldlaigan | Founder & CEO | VC Investor turned Founder | Product Execution & Market Insight |

Team Assessment:

| Metric                      | Evaluation Criteria                              | Assessment Basis                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Score (1–5) |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| Skills                      | Founder Alignment with Company Needs             | Founder/CEO Ibrahim Aldlaigan's VC (STV) and consultancy (SIDF) expertise in Saudi markets perfectly aligns with billing/payments for SMEs; Founding Engineer Abdulrahman Alrahma adds deep engineering for local rails. | 5           |
| Cohesion                    | Role clarity across team                         | Defined roles: Aldlaigan vision/CEO, Alrahma engineering, presumed sales/ops support, 40% MoM growth and edtech-to-SaaS expansion indicate solid teamwork.                                                               | 4           |
| Integrity & Trustworthiness | Alignment with investor expectations             | \$4M seed from Outliers VC, BYLD, Careem co-founder angels; praised for technical excellence and local insight by investors.                                                                                             | 5           |
| Execution Risk              | Dependence on original Founder (Key Person Risk) | Very high key-person risk on solo founder Aldlaigan (first-time CEO); young team lacks depth for rapid MENA scaling.                                                                                                     | 2           |
| Motivation & Commitment     | Willingness & Ability to accept opportunity cost | Aldlaigan left STV VC for founding; 40% MoM growth, millions processed in <1 year show intense drive.                                                                                                                    | 5           |
| Complementarity             | Complementary Team Skill Set                     | Strong founder engineering/sales mix, but limited visibility on full team skills beyond core duo—needs more finance/compliance depth.                                                                                    | 3           |
| Experience                  | Prior startup / Exit Experience                  | Aldlaigan: no prior startups (VC/consulting only); Alrahma likely early-career; no exits or serial founders evident                                                                                                      | 2           |

Sources: Stream, Gompers et al., 2020, Pitchbook, Stream, LinkedIn

# Appendix: Stream Risk Analysis

| Risk Category     | Description & Data                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Current Risk                                                                               | Mitigation Strategy                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Future Risk                                                                                      |
|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Regulatory        | SAMA regulates payment services via Payment Services Provider (PSP) framework, Stream requires SAMA PSP license (Category A or B depending on transaction limits). 224 licensed fintech companies in KSA by Q2 2024 (Ministry of Finance), competitive sandbox. Shariah compliance review required for any credit/BNPL features added to billing platform. SAMA Open Banking Framework (2022) enables data access but adds detailed management obligations. SAMA sandbox available — 30+ companies tested; approval cycle 6–12 months.                                                       | Low<br>(SAMA sandbox pathway clear; KSA most active GCC fintech regulator)                 | Engage SAMA sandbox early for PSP license pathway; appoint dedicated Shariah compliance advisor; monitor SAMA Open Banking API standards updates; hire ex-SAMA regulatory affairs lead.                                                                            | Medium<br>(expansion to UAE/Bahrain adds cross-border PSP complexity; SAMA rules evolving)       |
| Data / Compliance | Saudi Personal Data Protection Law (PDPL) enacted 2021, enforced Sep 2023, fines up to SAR 5M (~\$1.33M) for violations. Stream processes recurring billing data (bank accounts, invoices, payment schedules), high-sensitivity PII. SAMA requires data localisation for financial data within KSA. Open Banking data sharing requires explicit customer consent per SAMA framework. B2B billing platforms face audit risk from ZATCA (tax authority) for e-invoicing compliance. ZATCA Phase 2 e-invoicing (integration phase) mandatory for all VAT-registered businesses from 2023.       | Medium<br>(PDPL in force; ZATCA e-invoicing obligations apply to B2B platform clients)     | PDPL-compliant data architecture with local KSA hosting; ZATCA-certified e-invoicing module built into billing platform; customer consent management system; quarterly compliance audits; data classification policy for PII vs. transactional data.               | High<br>(PDPL enforcement tightening in 2026; ZATCA Phase 2 full rollout raises audit exposure)  |
| Market Adoption   | Saudi Arabia: 79% of retail transactions digital in 2024 (SAMA/Thunes); only ~7% recurring, massive white space. 97% smartphone penetration; 71% of population under 35, digitally native SME owners. Target customers: schools (tuition), gyms, SaaS companies, property managers. SME sector: 700,000+ active businesses in KSA (MONSHA'AT 2024); but SME digital payment adoption still growing from low base. Manual/semi-manual billing persists due to lack of awareness, not lack of demand.                                                                                          | Medium<br>(platform launched 2024; subscriber base fast-growing per investor announcement) | Direct SME outreach via MONSHA'AT ecosystem and Fintech Saudi network; freemium model for low-friction onboarding; bank partnerships for embedded billing within SME banking portals; Arabic-first UX critical for adoption.                                       | Medium<br>(KSA Vision 2030 digital SME enablement accelerates addressable market)                |
| Sales Execution   | Founder-led sales at seed stage, Ibrahim Aldaigan (investor background, product focus). Enterprise B2B sales (schools, corporates, gyms) requires dedicated account management. KSA business culture: relationship-driven procurement cycles take 3–6 months. Geopolitical disruption (Mar 2026 Iran strikes): Tadawul down, Vision 2030 projects paused, corporate spending freeze risk. Ras Tanura refinery strike raises energy cost uncertainty. Competing platforms: HyperPay, Geidea, Moyasar already have large KSA SME bases.                                                        | Medium<br>(early growth stage; strong investor signal from Careem co-founder)              | Hire VP Sales with KSA enterprise relationships; leverage Careem co-founder network; partner with accounting software providers (Qoyod, Foodics) for bundled distribution; activate geopolitical contingency plan for client communications.                       | High<br>(profitability pressure + geopolitical uncertainty compresses sales cycles)              |
| Scalability       | KSA-only initial focus, MENA expansion (UAE, Bahrain, Egypt) requires new PSP licenses in each jurisdiction. SAMA's data localisation rules prevent easy multi-market architecture. Recurring payment automation at scale requires bank-grade reliability (99.99% uptime SLA). KSA Fintech market: \$39.91B in 2024, projected \$125B by 2034 at 13.7% CAGR (SDK.Finance). Well-funded regional competitors (HyperPay raised \$36.7M; Geidea raised \$150M) have infrastructure lead. Open Banking API standardisation across GCC still fragmented.                                          | Low<br>(KSA-focused; no multi-market complexity yet; seed capital limited to KSA build)    | Modular cloud architecture designed for multi-market from day one; engage Fintech Saudi & DIFC/ADGM for regional expansion licensing roadmap; API-first design enables white-labelling by banks as distribution channel.                                           | Very High<br>(cross-border KSA-UAE-Bahrain fragmentation; capital requirements escalate rapidly) |
| Tech              | Recurring billing platforms are prime targets for authorised push payment (APP) fraud, UK Finance reports APP fraud at £460M in 2023; MENA equivalent undisclosed but growing. Integration with Saudi banks' Open Banking APIs introduces third-party dependency risk. SAMA mandates 3DS authentication for digital payments, adds UX friction. Geopolitical risk: Ras Tanura drone strike (Mar 2026) near Aramco data centres raises questions about KSA cloud infrastructure resilience. No disclosed tech certifications (PCI-DSS, SOC2) at seed stage — required for enterprise clients. | Low<br>(early stage; limited disclosed tech incidents; SAMA-compliant design required)     | PCI-DSS Level 1 compliance roadmap; multi-region cloud (AWS Bahrain + Azure KSA); fraud detection layer using ML on billing anomalies; SAMA 3DS compliance built-in; pursue SOC2 Type II within 18 months; business continuity plan for KSA infrastructure events. | Medium<br>(attack surface grows with volume; KSA cloud infra risk flagged Mar 2026)              |

Sources: Stream Seed Round Announcement, Wamda, Arab Founders, SAMA, Saudi PDPL Enforcement, ZATCA, Saudi / SAMA Open Banking Framework, finance KSA Fintech Report, MONSHA'AT SME Statistics, Thunes KSA Digital, Vision 2030 Financial Sector Development Program, UK Finance APP Fraud Report, ILGC Fintech Laws KSA, ACLED / Jane's